

Fluid Mechanics

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Lecture 1: Introduction to Fluid Mechanics

25. August 2025

1 Fundamental Concepts

1.1 Fluid as a Continuum

Fluids are normally experienced as being continuous or “smooth” when perceived in the macroscopic world. If one looks at a fluid microscopically one would start to see that the fluid is not continuous at all but instead composed of distinct particles. We wish to determine the minimum volume, $\partial V'$ that a point C must be such that we can talk about the fluid being continuous at this point. In other words, under what circumstances can a fluid be treated as a continuum, for which, by definition, properties vary smoothly over all points.

We define the mass ∂m as the instantaneous number of molecules in ∂V and the mass of each of these molecules. The average density inside volume ∂V is hence given by $\rho = \frac{\partial m}{\partial V}$. It is important to note that this necessarily is an *average value* as the number of molecules in ∂V and hence the density fluctuates. Due to the law of large numbers one will experience that for very small volume the density will fluctuate greatly over time, however at a certain volume $\partial V'$, the density becomes stable and will not fluctuate greatly over time. For $\partial V = 0,001 \text{ mm}^3$ (about the size of a grain of sand) there will already be an average of $2,5 \cdot 10^{13}$ molecules present. Hence a liquid can be treated as a continuous medium as long as we consider a “point” to be no smaller than about this size – at least this is sufficiently precise for most engineering applications.

This continuum hypothesis is an integral part of fluid mechanics. It is valid when treating the behaviour of fluids under normal conditions and only breaks down when the mean free path of the molecules becomes the same order of magnitude as the smallest characteristic dimension of the problem.

As a consequence of the continuum assumption, each property of the fluid is assumed to have a definite value at each point in space. I.e. density, temperature, velocity, and so on are each continuous functions of both position and time. We now have a definition of the density at a point:

$$\rho \equiv \lim_{\partial V \rightarrow \partial V'} \frac{\partial m}{\partial V}.$$

As point C was chosen arbitrarily the density at any other point in the liquid can be determined in the same manner. If one measures this simultaneously for all points in the fluid, an expression for the density distribution as a function of the space coordinates $\rho = \rho(x, y, z)$ can be found.

The density at a specific point may also vary with time. Therefore the complete representation of density, the so-called *field representation*, can be written as:

$$\rho = \rho(x, y, z, t) \tag{1}$$

As density is a scalar quantity the field given by Equation 1 is a scalar field.

The density can also be expressed as the specific gravity, i.e. the weight compared to the maximum density of water, $\rho_{\text{H}_2\text{O}} = 1000 \frac{\text{kg}}{\text{m}^3}$ at 4°C . Thus the specific gravity of a substance can be found as:

$$\text{SG} = \frac{\rho}{\rho_{\text{H}_2\text{O}}}.$$

Another useful property is the *specific weight*, γ , of a substance. It is defined as the weight of a substance per unit volume, i.e.:

$$\gamma = \frac{mg}{V} \implies \gamma = \rho g.$$

1.2 Velocity field

A very important property defined by a field is the velocity field, given by:

$$\mathbf{V} = \mathbf{V}(x, y, z, t) \quad (2)$$

As velocity is a vector quantity, the field given in Equation 2 is a vector field.

The velocity vector, $\mathbf{V}$, can also be written in terms of its scalar components. Denoting the components in the x -, y -, and z -directions by u , v , and w , respectively we get:

$$\mathbf{V} = u\hat{i} + v\hat{j} + w\hat{k}.$$

Here, each component, u , v , and w , will generally be functions of x , y , z and t .

We also need to be make sure to remember that $\mathbf{V}(x, y, z, t)$ represents the velocity of a fluid particle passing through the point (x, y, z) at time t . Therefore $\mathbf{V}(x, y, z, t)$ should be thought of as the velocity field of the entire fluid and not of an individual particle.

If properties at every point in a flow field are constant with respect to time, the flow is termed *steady*. This is defined mathematically as:

$$\frac{\partial \eta}{\partial t} = 0.$$

Where η is any fluid property. Hence, for steady flow:

$$\frac{\partial \rho}{\partial t} = 0 \text{ or } \rho = \rho(x, y, z)$$

and

$$\frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial t} = 0 \text{ or } \mathbf{V} = \mathbf{V}(x, y, z).$$

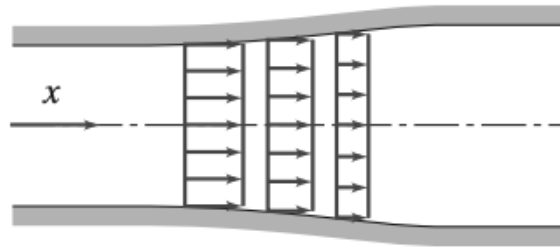
As such any property may vary from point to point in the field but remain constant with time at every point for steady flow.

1.3 One-, Two-, and Three-Dimensional flows

A flow is either one-, two-, or three-dimensional depending on the amount of spatial coordinates required to specify the velocity field. Equation 2 shows that the velocity field in some cases is a function of three spatial coordinates and time – in this case it is a three-dimensional flow.

Almost all flows are three-dimensional in nature – however, analysis based on fewer dimensions is often sufficient. The complexity of analysis increases sharply as more dimensions are added, and oftentimes in engineering a one-dimensional analysis is sufficient.

To not break the continuum assumption all fluids must have zero velocity at any solid surface, e.g. the inner side of a pipe. Due to this all flow in pipes is inherently three-dimensional. To simplify the analysis one often uses the notion of *uniform flow* at a given cross-section. In a flow that is uniform at a given cross-section, the velocity is constant across any section normal to the flow as shown in **Figure 1.1**. Under this assumption, the flow simplifies to be simply a function of x alone. The term *uniform flow field* is used to describe a flow in which the velocity is constant throughout the entire field.

Figure 1.1: *Uniform flow* at a given cross-section.**Definition 1: Uniform flow at a cross section**

An assumption that states that a fluid has the same velocity everywhere in a given cross section as shown on **Figure 1.1**. This actually breaks the continuum hypothesis but it makes a lot of calculations easier.

Definition 2: Uniform flow field

A flow field where the velocity is constant everywhere throughout the flow field.

1.4 Timelines, Pathlines, Streaklines, and Streamlines

Wind tunnels have traditionally often utilized to visualize flow fields. In modern times the advent of computer simulations has meant that these have become much more prevalent recently. A few different terms must be defined for proper understanding of these.

Definition 3: Timeline

A *timeline* is produced by marking adjacent fluid particles in a flow field at a given instant. Subsequent observation of the timeline can give insights into the flow field.

Definition 4: Pathline

A *pathline* is the trajectory traced out by a moving fluid particle. These can be visualized by marking a fluid particle at a given instant, e.g. with dye or smoke, and then tracing the path of this particle as it moves through the field.

Definition 5: Streakline

A *streakline* is the line traced out by marking the fluid particles at a fixed point in space, e.g. with smoke or dye. This is therefore a way to see how fluid particles that passed through a specific point behave afterwards.

Definition 6: Streamlines

A *streamline* are lines drawn in a flow field such that at any given instant they are tangent to the velocity vector at every point in the flow. This means there can be no flow across a streamline. These

are the most commonly used visualization technique

We can use the velocity field to derive the shapes of streaklines, pathlines and streamlines. As the streamlines are parallel to the velocity vector, for a two dimensional flow field, we can write:

$$\left. \frac{dy}{dx} \right|_{\text{streamline}} = \frac{v(x, y)}{u(x, y)} \quad (3)$$

Note that these are obtained at a given instant in time. If the flow is unsteady, time t is held constant in **Equation 3**. Solution of the equation gives $y = y(x)$, with an undetermined integration constant, the value of which depends on the particular streamline.

For pathlines, we let $x = x_p(t)$ and $y = y_p(t)$ where $x_p(t)$ and $y_p(t)$ are the instantaneous coordinates of a specific particle. In this case we get

$$\left. \frac{dx}{dt} \right|_{\text{particle}} = u(x, y, t) \quad \left. \frac{dy}{dt} \right|_{\text{particle}} = v(x, y, t) \quad (4)$$

The simultaneous solution of these equations gives the path of a particle in parametric form, $x_p(t), y_p(t)$.

For streaklines, the first step is to compute the pathline of a particle with Equation 4 that was released from the streak source at x_0, y_0 at time t_0 , in the form

$$x_{\text{particle}}(t) = x(t, x_0, y_0, t_0) \quad y_{\text{particle}}(t) = y(t, x_0, y_0, t_0).$$

Then now, instead of interpreting this as the position of a particle over time, we instead write the equations as:

$$x_{\text{streakline}}(t_0) = x(t, x_0, y_0, t_0) \quad y_{\text{streakline}}(t_0) = y(t, x_0, y_0, t_0) \quad (5)$$

Equation 5 gives the line generated (by time t) from a streak source placed at (x_0, y_0) . In these equations t_0 is varied from 0 to t to show the *instantaneous* positions of all particles released up to time t .

1.5 Stress Field

To understand the behaviour of fluids one must first understand the nature of the forces that act upon fluid particles. A fluid particle can experience either:

- *Surface forces*, e.g. pressure or friction, that are generated due to contact with other particles or surfaces
- *Body forces*, e.g. gravity and electromagnetic, that are experienced throughout the particle.

Surface forces on a fluid particle leads to *stresses*. Stress is an important concept when describing how forces acting on the boundaries of a medium are transmitted throughout the medium.

We consider the surface of a particle in contact with other fluid particles and the contact force being generated between these. Let $\delta \mathbf{A}$ be a portion of the surface at some point C . The orientation of $\delta \mathbf{A}$ is given by the unit vector $\hat{n}$, which is perpendicular to the surface as seen in **Figure 1.2**.

The force, $\delta\mathbf{F}$, acting on the surface portion $\delta\mathbf{A}$ may be split into two components – a *normal stress* σ_n normal to the surface and a *shear stress* τ_n tangential to the surface, defined as:

$$\sigma_n = \lim_{\delta A_n \rightarrow 0} \frac{\delta F_n}{\delta A_n}$$

$$\tau_n = \lim_{\delta A_n \rightarrow 0} \frac{\delta F_t}{\delta A_n}.$$

The subscript n on the stress is a reminder that the stresses are associated with the surface portion $\delta\mathbf{A}$ through C , which has an outward normal in the $\hat{n}$ direction.

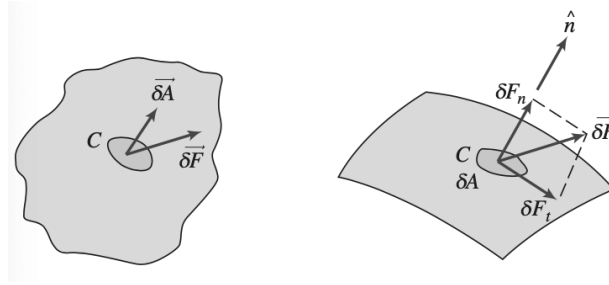


Figure 1.2: Stress in a continuum.

We consider the stress on the element δA_x whose normal is in the $+x$ -direction. We can then split the force acting upon this point $\delta\mathbf{F}$ into components along each coordinate direction. By dividing the magnitude of each force component by the area δA_x and taking the limit as δA_x approaches zero we define three stress components as:

$$\sigma_{xx} = \lim_{\delta A_x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\delta F_x}{\delta A_x}$$

$$\tau_{xy} = \lim_{\delta A_x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\delta F_y}{\delta A_x}$$

$$\tau_{xz} = \lim_{\delta A_x \rightarrow 0} \frac{\delta F_z}{\delta A_x}.$$

This is also shown graphically in **Figure 1.3**.

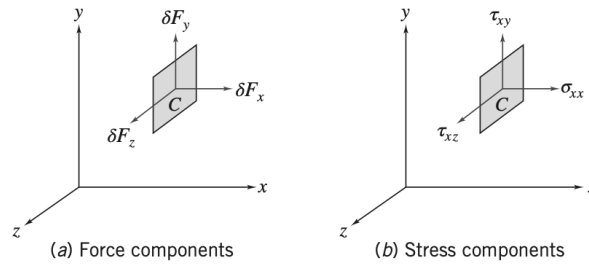


Figure 1.3: Force and stresses at surface element δA_x

Here the first subscript (x) indicates the *plane* on which the stress acts, in this case a surface perpendicular to the x -axis. The second direction indicates the *direction* in which the stress acts. I.e. consideration of the element δA_y would lead to the stresses σ_{yy} , τ_{yx} and τ_{yz} and similarly for δA_z .

As the coordinate system was chosen arbitrarily it is easily realized that one can define an infinite amount of stresses through a point C depending on how the axes are placed. Luckily, the state of stress at any point

is completely described by the stresses acting in any three mutually perpendicular planes through the point. Therefore the stress at a point is specified by the nine components:

$$\begin{bmatrix} \sigma_{xx} & \tau_{xy} & \tau_{xz} \\ \tau_{yx} & \sigma_{yy} & \tau_{yz} \\ \tau_{zx} & \tau_{zy} & \sigma_{zz} \end{bmatrix}.$$

Planes are normally named for the direction in which their normal vector is pointing. Also we normally define a stress component to be positive when the stress component and the plane on which it acts are either both positive or negative.

1.6 Viscosity

For a solid stresses develop when the material is elastically deformed or strained; for a fluid, shear stresses instead arise due to viscosity. For a fluid at rest there will be no shear stresses.

We consider the behaviour of a fluid element between two infinite planes sketched on **Figure 1.4**. The rectangular fluid element is initially at rest at time t . We now suppose a constant rightward force δF_x is applied to the upper plate such that it is dragged across the fluid at constant velocity δu . The shearing action of the plates produces a shear stress τ_{yx} , which acts on the fluid element, and is given by:

$$\tau_{yx} = \lim_{\delta A_y \rightarrow 0} \frac{\delta F_x}{\delta A_y} = \frac{dF_x}{dA_y}$$

where δA_y is the contact area between the fluid element between the plate and δF_x is the force exerted by the plate on the element.

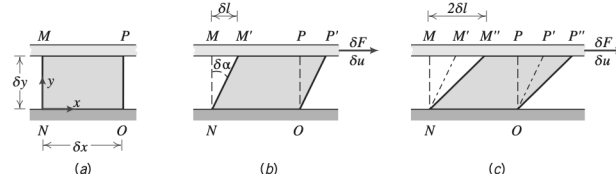


Figure 1.4: (a) Fluid element at time t , (b) deformation of fluid element at time $t + \delta t$, (c) deformation of fluid element at time $t + 2\delta t$

Focusing on the time interval δt (**Figure 1.4b**) the deformation of the fluid is given by:

$$\text{deformation rate} = \lim_{\delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{\delta \alpha}{\delta t} = \frac{d\alpha}{dt}.$$

We will now seek to express $\frac{d\alpha}{dt}$ in terms of measurable quantities. The distance, δl , between the points M and M' is given by:

$$\delta l = \delta u \delta t.$$

For small angles this simplifies to:

$$\delta l = \delta y \delta \alpha.$$

Equating these two expressions gives:

$$\frac{\delta\alpha}{\delta t} = \frac{\delta u}{\delta y}.$$

By taking the limits of both sides of this, we get:

$$\frac{d\alpha}{dt} = \frac{du}{dy}.$$

Thus, the fluid element will, when subjected to a shear stress τ_{yx} , experience a rate of deformation given by $\frac{du}{dy}$. We have thus established that any fluid will flow and have a shear rate when subjected to a shear stress. Fluids in which the shear stress is proportional to the deformation rate are termed *Newtonian* and fluids for which this is not the case are termed *non-Newtonian*.

1.7 Newtonian Fluid

Most common fluids are Newtonian under normal conditions. If the fluid on **Figure 1.4** is Newtonian, then:

$$\tau_{yx} \propto \frac{du}{dy}.$$

The constant of proportionality between these two quantities is the *absolute viscosity* also called the dynamic viscosity, μ . Thus in terms of the coordinates on **Figure 1.4** Newton's law of viscosity for one-dimensional flow is:

$$\tau_{yx} = \mu \frac{du}{dy} \quad (6)$$

By dimensional analysis on **Equation 6** it can be seen that the units of viscosity are kg / m s or Pa s.

In fluid mechanics the ratio of absolute viscosity μ to density ρ often arises. This ratio is called the *kinematic viscosity* and is represented by ν . The units for this is 1 stoke $\equiv$ 1 cm² / s.

1.8 Non-Newtonian Fluids

Many empirical equations have been proposed to model the observed relations between τ_{yx} and $\frac{du}{dy}$ for time-independent non-Newtonian fluids. For many engineering applications the power law model is sufficient, for which one-dimensional flow becomes:

$$\tau_{yx} = k \left(\frac{du}{dy} \right)^n.$$

Here n is called the *flow behaviour index* and k is called the *consistency index*. Newton's law of viscosity is a special case of this with $n = 1$ and $k = \mu$. To ensure that τ_{yx} has the same sign as $\frac{du}{dy}$ the equation is rewritten as:

$$\tau_{yx} = k \left| \frac{du}{dy} \right|^{n-1} \frac{du}{dy} = \eta \frac{du}{dy} \quad (7)$$

Here the term $\eta = k \left| \frac{du}{dy} \right|^{n-1}$ is referred to as the *apparent viscosity*. When using **Equation 7** we end up with a viscosity η that is used in a formula in the same form as **Equation 6**. The big difference between these two is that while μ is constant (at a constant temperature), η depends on the shear rate.

Fluids for which the apparent viscosity decreases with increasing deformation rate ($n < 1$) are called *pseudoplastic* or shear thinning fluids. Most non-Newtonian fluids are of this type. If the apparent viscosity increases with deformation rate ($n > 1$) the fluid is termed *dilatant* or shear thickening.

A “fluid” that behaves as a solid until a minimum yield stress τ_y is exceeded and subsequently exhibits a linear relation between stress rate and deformation is termed an ideal or *Bingham plastic*. The shear stress model for a Bingham plastic is:

$$\tau_{yx} = \tau_y + \mu_p \frac{du}{dy}.$$

The apparent viscosity may also be time-dependent. *Thixotropic* fluids show a decrease in η with time at a constant stress and *Rheopectic* fluids show an increase in η with time. Some fluids partially return to their original shape when the stress is removed – these are called *viscoelastic*.

1.9 Surface Tension

Droplets can either “flatten out” or remain as little drops when dropped on a surface. We define a liquid as *wetting* a surface when the contact angle is $< 90^\circ$. This is shown on **Figure 1.5**.

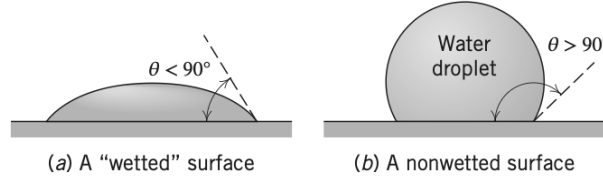


Figure 1.5: Surface tension effects on water droplets.

Surface tension arises at the interface between the liquid and a solid – this interface acts like a stretched elastic membrane in turn creating surface tension. This membrane is completely described by two features: the contact angle θ and the magnitude of the surface tension σ [N/m]. Both of these depend on both the type of liquid and the characteristics of the surface with which it shares an interface.

1.10 Description and Classification of Fluid Motions

The two most difficult aspects of a fluid mechanics analysis to deal with are: (1) the fluid's viscous nature and (2) its compressibility. When fluid mechanics first was developed it was occupied with a frictionless and incompressible fluid. Whilst extremely elegant this leads to the infamous result called d'Alembert's paradox, which states that all bodies experience zero drag as they move through a liquid – which of course is not consistent with observations.

1.10.1 Viscous and Inviscid Flows

Any object moving through a fluid will experience gravity and an aerodynamic drag force. This drag force is in part due to viscous friction and in part due to pressure differences being produced as the liquid moves out of the way of the object. We can estimate whether or not viscous forces are negligible compared to pressure forces by computing the Reynolds number:

$$\text{Re} = \rho \frac{VL}{\mu}.$$

where ρ and μ are the density and viscosity of the fluid, respectively, and V and L are the “characteristic” velocity and size scale of the flow, respectively. If the Reynolds number is “large” viscous effects will be small; however, if the Reynolds number is neither large nor small, both are important.

The idealized notion of frictionless flow is called *inviscid flow*. It predicts streamlines as shown in **Figure 1.6a**. These streamlines are symmetric front to back. As flow between two streamlines is constant the velocity in the vicinity of points *A* and *C* must be relatively low compared to the velocity at point *B*. Hence, points *A* and *C* have large pressures whereas *B* will be a point of low pressure. In fact, the pressure distribution around the sphere is symmetric and there is therefore no net drag force due to pressure. As we are assuming inviscid flow there will be no drag force due to friction either – this is the d’Alembert paradox of 1752.

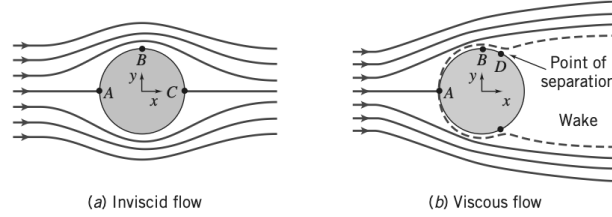


Figure 1.6: Incompressible flow over a sphere

The answer to this was obtained by Prandtl in 1904. The no-slip condition requires that the velocity everywhere at the surface of the ball must be zero, but inviscid theory states that it is high at point *B*. Prandtl suggested that even though friction is negligible for high-Reynolds number flows, there will always be a thin boundary layer, in which friction is significant and over which the velocity will increase rapidly from zero at the surface to the value predicted by inviscid theory at the edge of the boundary layer.

This thin boundary layer explains why drag arises. The boundary layer however also has another important consequence. It often leads to bodies moving through a fluid having a *wake* as shown on **Figure 1.6b**. Here point *D* is termed a *separation point*, where fluid particles are pushed off the object thus creating the wake. It turns out that this wake always will have low pressure compared to the front of the sphere, hence the sphere now experiences quite a large *pressure* or *form drag*.

We can now also begin to see how *streamlining* works. The main drag force in most aerodynamics is due to the low pressure wake. If we can reduce or even eliminate this wake the drag will be greatly reduced. Imagine that the sphere was instead teardrop shaped – the pressure gradient will not be changing as quickly along the back half of the object and thus the wake will be smaller leading to less drag. This illustrates the *very* significant difference between inviscid flow ($\mu = 0$) and flows where the viscosity can be assumed negligible but not zero ($\mu \rightarrow 0$).

1.10.2 Laminar and Turbulent flows

A faucet turned on at a very low flow rate will lead to water running out smoothly – if you increase the flow rate the water will exit in a much more chaotic manner. In fluid dynamics these are termed either *laminar flow* or *turbulent flow*. Oftentimes turbulence is unwanted but unavoidable.

The velocity of laminar flow is simply u . The velocity of turbulent flow is given by the mean velocity $\bar{u}$ plus the three components of randomly fluctuating velocity u' , v' , and w' . Many turbulent flows may be steady in the mean, but the presence of these random velocity fluctuations makes analysis of turbulent flows extremely difficult. In one-dimensional laminar flow, the shear stress is related to the velocity gradient by the simple relation:

$$\tau_{yx} = \mu \frac{du}{dy}.$$

For a turbulent flow, no such simple relation is valid. In turbulent flow momentum can be transported across

streamlines and therefore there is no universal relationship between the stress field and the mean-velocity field. This means we often have to rely on semi-empirical theories for analyzing turbulent flow.

1.10.3 Compressible and Incompressible Flows

A flow in which the variation in density is negligible is termed *incompressible* and those in which density variations are not negligible are called *compressible*. Gasses are normally treated as compressible, whereas liquids are normally treated as incompressible. At high temperatures, however, compressibility effects can start to become important. Pressure and density changes in liquids are related by the *bulk compressibility modulus* or the modulus of elasticity,

$$E_v \equiv \frac{dp}{\frac{d\rho}{\rho}}.$$

If the bulk modulus is independent of temperature, then density is only a function of pressure (the fluid is said to be *barotropic*).

Gas flows with negligible heat transfer can be considered incompressible so long as the flow speeds are small relative to the speed of sound. The ratio of flow speed, V , to the local speed of sound, c , in the gas is defined as the Mach number:

$$M \equiv \frac{V}{c}.$$

For $M < 0,3$ the maximum variation in density is less than 5%. Thus gas flows with $M < 0,3$ can be treated as being incompressible.

1.10.4 Internal and External Flows

Flows completely bounded by solid surfaces are called either *internal*, *pipe*, or *duct flows*. Flows over bodies immersed in an unbounded fluid are termed *external flows*.

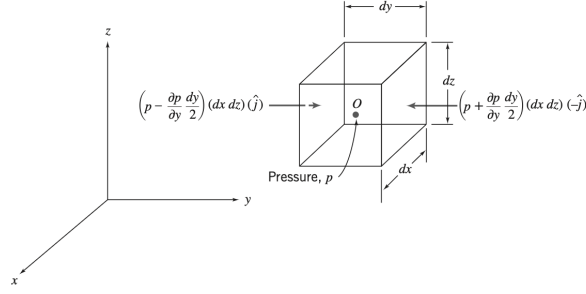
An example of an internal flow is that of water in a pipe. The Reynolds number for pipe flows is defined as $Re = \rho \bar{V} D / \mu$, where $\bar{V}$ is the average flow velocity and D is the pipe diameter. Based on this one can predict if the flow will be laminar or turbulent. For $Re < 2300$ the flow will generally be laminar and turbulent for larger values. Flow in a pipe of constant diameter will always be entirely laminar or entirely turbulent, depending on the value of the velocity $\bar{V}$.

Lecture 2: Basic equations of fluid statics and buoyancy, surface tension 27. August 2025

2 Fluid Statics

2.1 The basic equations of fluid statics

Consider a differential fluid element of mass $dm = \rho dV$ with sides dx , dy , and dz as shown on **Figure 2.1**. The fluid element is stationary relative to the coordinate system shown.


 Figure 2.1: Differential fluid element with pressure forces shown in the y -direction

It has previously been mentioned that only *body forces* and *surface forces* may be applied to a fluid. In this course the body forces caused by electric or magnetic fields is assumed negligible and only the gravitational force must therefore be accounted for.

For the differential fluid element the (gravitational) body force is:

$$d\mathbf{F}_B = \mathbf{g} dm = \mathbf{g} \rho dV.$$

where $\mathbf{g}$ denotes the local gravity vector, ρ is the density and dV is the volume of the fluid element. This can also be expressed as:

$$d\mathbf{F}_B = \rho \mathbf{g} dx dy dz.$$

Per definition there can be no shear stresses in a static fluid, so the only surface force is that due to pressure, which is a scalar field, $p = p(x, y, z)$. The net pressure force can be found by summing the forces on each of the six faces of the fluid element. The pressure at the center O is denoted p . The pressure at each face of the element will be found using a Taylor series expansion of the pressure about point O . The pressure on the left side of the fluid element is:

$$p_L = p + \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} (y_L - y) = p + \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} \left(-\frac{dy}{2} \right) = p - \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} \frac{dy}{2}.$$

Terms of higher order are omitted as they will vanish at a later step anyways. Similarly, the pressure on the right face of the differential element is:

$$p_R = p + \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} (y_R - y) = p + \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} \frac{dy}{2}.$$

The pressure *forces* produced by this pressure is shown on **Figure 2.1**. These consist of three factors. Namely the magnitude of the pressure, the area of the face and a unit vector to indicate direction. A positive pressure here is defined as a compressive pressure on the differential element. The pressure forces in the other directions can be obtained in the same way giving:

$$\begin{aligned} d\mathbf{F}_S = & \left(p - \frac{\partial p}{\partial x} \frac{dx}{2} \right) (dy dz) (\hat{\mathbf{i}}) + \left(p + \frac{\partial p}{\partial x} \frac{dx}{2} \right) (dy dz) (-\hat{\mathbf{i}}) \\ & + \left(p - \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} \frac{dy}{2} \right) (dx dz) (\hat{\mathbf{j}}) + \left(p + \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} \frac{dy}{2} \right) (dx dz) (-\hat{\mathbf{j}}) \\ & + \left(p - \frac{\partial p}{\partial z} \frac{dz}{2} \right) (dx dy) (\hat{\mathbf{k}}) + \left(p + \frac{\partial p}{\partial z} \frac{dz}{2} \right) (dx dy) (-\hat{\mathbf{k}}). \end{aligned}$$

Simplifying this, we obtain

$$d\mathbf{F}_S = - \left(\frac{\partial p}{\partial x} \hat{\mathbf{i}} + \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} \hat{\mathbf{j}} + \frac{\partial p}{\partial z} \hat{\mathbf{k}} \right) dx dy dz.$$

We can now recognize the term in the parentheses as the gradient of the pressure which may be written as either $\text{grad}p$ or ∇p . This is:

$$\text{grad}p \equiv \nabla p \equiv \left(\hat{\mathbf{i}} \frac{\partial p}{\partial x} + \hat{\mathbf{j}} \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} + \hat{\mathbf{k}} \frac{\partial p}{\partial z} \right) \equiv \left(\hat{\mathbf{i}} \frac{\partial}{\partial x} + \hat{\mathbf{j}} \frac{\partial}{\partial y} + \hat{\mathbf{k}} \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \right) p.$$

Using this notation we can rewrite the expression as:

$$d\mathbf{F}_S = -\text{grad}p(dx dy dz) = -\nabla p dx dy dz.$$

Note that the pressure magnitude is not relevant when computing the net pressure force – instead only the rate of change of pressure with distance, the pressure gradient, is needed.

We can now combine the expressions for the surface and body forces on the fluid element.

$$d\mathbf{F} = d\mathbf{F}_S + d\mathbf{F}_B = (-\nabla p + \rho \mathbf{g}) dx dy dz = (-\nabla p + \rho \mathbf{g}) dV$$

which can also be stated as the force acting per unit volume as

$$\frac{d\mathbf{F}}{dV} = -\nabla p + \rho \mathbf{g}.$$

Applying Newton's second law to a static fluid particle gives

$$\mathbf{F} = \mathbf{a} dm = \mathbf{0} dm = \mathbf{0}.$$

Thus

$$\frac{d\mathbf{F}}{dV} = \rho \mathbf{a} = \mathbf{0}.$$

Combining these two gives:

$$-\nabla p + \rho \mathbf{g} = \mathbf{0}.$$

This can be stated in words as the sum of the net pressure force per unit volume at a point and the body force per unit volume at a point is zero. As this is a three-dimensional vector equation it is comprised of three individual equations that must each be satisfied individually.

$$\begin{aligned} -\frac{\partial p}{\partial x} + \rho g_x &= 0 \\ -\frac{\partial p}{\partial y} + \rho g_y &= 0 \\ -\frac{\partial p}{\partial z} + \rho g_z &= 0. \end{aligned}$$

It is now convenient to choose a coordinate system such that the gravity vector is aligned with one of the axes. If we place the coordinate system “normally” we would get $g_x = 0$, $g_y = 0$, and $g_z = -g$. The component equations then become

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial p}{\partial x} &= 0 \\ \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} &= 0 \\ \frac{\partial p}{\partial z} &= -\rho g. \end{aligned}$$

This means that the pressure depends on one variable only and the total derivative may therefore be employed instead of the partial as

$$\frac{\partial p}{\partial z} = -\rho g \equiv -\gamma.$$

This is the basic pressure-height relation of fluid statics.

2.2 Pressure variation in a static fluid

2.2.1 Incompressible fluids

For an incompressible fluid $\rho = \text{constant}$. If we assume the gravity to be constant with elevation then we get

$$\frac{\partial p}{\partial z} = -\rho g = \text{constant}.$$

Now we can easily integrate this as

$$\int_{p_0}^p dp = - \int_{z_0}^z \rho g dz.$$

The height difference is defined as $h = z_0 - z$ and thus we upon integration obtain

$$p - p_0 = \Delta p = \rho g h.$$

To find the pressure difference Δp between two points separated by a series of fluid, we can compute the change in pressure as

$$\Delta p = g \sum_i \rho_i h_i.$$

2.2.2 Gases

Pressure variation in a compressible fluid must be found by integration of the previous result. First, however, an expression for the density as a function of either p or z must be found. To do this we employ the ideal gas law:

$$p = \rho R T.$$

Here the temperature T is introduced as an additional variable. In the U.S. Standard Atmosphere, the temperature decreases linearly with altitude up to an elevation of 11,0 km. Therefore the temperature can be expressed as:

$$T = T_0 - m z.$$

We therefore get

$$dp = -\rho g dz = -\frac{pg}{RT} dz = -\frac{pg}{R(T_0 - mz)} dz.$$

By separation of variables we obtain:

$$\int_{p_0}^p \frac{dp}{p} = - \int_0^z \frac{g dz}{R(T_0 - mz)}.$$

Which gives

$$\ln \frac{p}{p_0} = \frac{g}{mR} \ln \left(\frac{T_0 - mz}{T_0} \right) = \frac{g}{mR} \ln \left(1 - \frac{mz}{T_0} \right).$$

Which can be solved for p as

$$p = p_0 \left(1 - \frac{mz}{T_0} \right)^{\frac{g}{mR}} = p_0 \left(\frac{T}{T_0} \right)^{\frac{g}{mR}}.$$

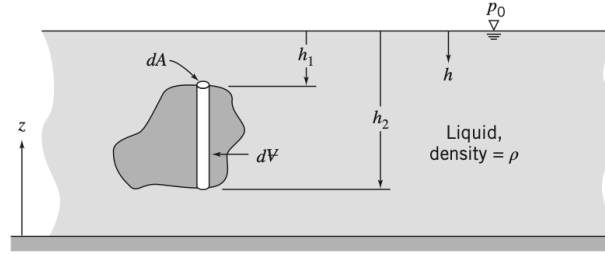


Figure 2.2: Immersed body in a static liquid.

2.3 Buoyancy

Any object submerged in a liquid will experience a vertical force acting on it due to liquid pressure – this is termed *buoyancy*. Consider the object on **Figure 2.2** which is split into cylindrical volume elements.

We have previously derived an equation for the pressure p at depth h in a liquid:

$$p = p_0 + \rho gh.$$

The net vertical force on the element is thus

$$dF_z = (p_0 + \rho gh_2) dA - (p_0 + \rho gh_1) dA = \rho g (h_2 - h_1) dA.$$

As $(h_2 - h_1) dA = dV$ we get

$$F_z = \int dF_z = \int_V \rho g dV = \rho g V.$$

I.e. for a submerged body, the buoyancy force is equal to the weight of the displaced fluid.

Lecture 3: Control volume analysis I: Basic laws and mass conservation 1. September 2025

3 Basic Equations in Integral Form for a Control Volume

In general, there are two approaches to study flowing fluids. Either one can study how an individual particle or group of particles move through space, this is often called the *system approach*. This often leads to one needing to solve a set of partial differential equations.

One can also choose to study a region of space as fluid flows through it; this is the *control volume* approach. This has widespread applications, e.g. in aerodynamics where the focus is often on the lift and drag on a wing rather than the individual fluid particles.

3.1 Basic Laws for a System

A few basic laws will be applied; these are conservation of mass, Newton's second law, the angular-momentum principle, and the first and second laws of thermodynamics. It turns out that to convert these system equations to equivalent control volume formulas we will express the properties of the system in terms of the rates of flow in and out, hence these equations are termed *rate equations*.

3.1.1 Conservation of Mass

For a system we have the simple result that $M = \text{constant}$. To express this law as a rate equation we write:

$$\left(\frac{dM}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}} = 0$$

where

$$M_{\text{system}} = \int_{M(\text{system})} dm = \int_{V(\text{system})} \rho dV.$$

3.1.2 Newton's Second Law

For a system (the fluid) moving relative to an inertial reference frame (the control volume), Newton's second law states that the sum of all external forces acting on the system is equal to the time rate of change of the linear momentum of the system,

$$\mathbf{F} = \left(\frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}}$$

where the linear momentum of the system is given by

$$\mathbf{P}_{\text{system}} = \int_{M(\text{system})} \mathbf{V} dm = \int_{V(\text{system})} \mathbf{V} \rho dV.$$

3.1.3 The Angular-Momentum Principle

The angular-momentum principle for a system states that the rate change of angular momentum is equal to the sum of all torques acting on the system:

$$\mathbf{T} = \left(\frac{d\mathbf{H}}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}}$$

where the angular momentum of the system is given by

$$\mathbf{H}_{M(\text{system})} = \int_{M(\text{system})} \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{V} dm = \int_{V(\text{system})} \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{V} \rho dV.$$

Torque can be produced both by surface and body forces and also by shafts that cross the system boundary,

$$\mathbf{T} = \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{F}_s + \int_{M(\text{system})} \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{g} dm + \mathbf{T}_{\text{shaft}}.$$

3.1.4 The First Law of Thermodynamics

The first law of thermodynamics is a statement of conservation of energy for a system,

$$\delta Q - \delta W = dE.$$

Which in rate form is

$$\dot{Q} - \dot{W} = \left(\frac{dE}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}}$$

where the total energy of the system is

$$E_{\text{system}} = \int_{M(\text{system})} e \, dm = \int_{V(\text{system})} e \rho \, dV$$

and

$$e = u + \frac{V^2}{2} + gz.$$

Here $\dot{Q}$ is positive when heat is added to the system; $\dot{W}$ is positive when work is done by the system on its surroundings; u is the specific internal energy, V the speed, and z the height relative to a particle of substance with mass dm .

3.1.5 The Second Law of Thermodynamics

When an amount of heat, δQ , is transferred to a system at temperature T , the second law of thermodynamics states that the change in entropy, dS , of the system satisfies,

$$dS \geq \frac{\delta Q}{T}.$$

On a rate basis this is

$$\left(\frac{dS}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}} \geq \frac{1}{T} \dot{Q}$$

where the total entropy of the system is given by

$$S_{\text{system}} = \int_{M(\text{system})} s \, dm = \int_{V(\text{system})} s \rho \, dV.$$

3.1.6 Relation of System derivatives to the control volume formulation

Let any of the parameters $M, \mathbf{P}, \mathbf{H}, E$, or S be represented by the symbol N . Corresponding to the extensive property (N) that we are trying to find we, will need the intensive (i.e., per unit mass) property η . Thus:

$$N_{\text{system}} = \int_{M(\text{system})} \eta \, dm = \int_{V(\text{system})} \eta \rho \, dV.$$

I.e. if:

$N = M,$	then $\eta = 1$
$N = \mathbf{P},$	then $\eta = \mathbf{V}$
$N = \mathbf{H},$	then $\eta = \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{V}$
$N = E,$	then $\eta = e$
$N = S,$	then $\eta = s.$

3.1.7 Derivation

Let t represent the initial time for the system and $t + \Delta t$ represent a small time increment later. Our objective here is to relate any arbitrary extensive property, N , of the system to quantities associated with the control

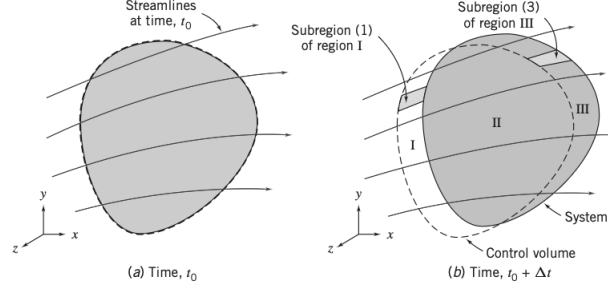


Figure 3.1: Configuration of the system and control volume.

volume. From the definition of the derivative, the rate of change of N_{system} is

$$\left. \frac{dN}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}} \equiv \lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{N_s(t_0 + \Delta t) - N_s(t_0)}{\Delta t} \quad (8)$$

Here subscript s is used to denote the system.

From the geometry of **Figure 3.1**,

$$N_s(t_0 + \Delta t) = (N_{\text{II}} + N_{\text{III}})_{t_0 + \Delta t} = (N_{\text{CV}} - N_{\text{I}} + N_{\text{III}})_{t_0 + \Delta t}$$

and

$$N_s(t_0) = (N_{\text{CV}})_{t_0}.$$

Substituting these into the definition of the system derivative in **Equation 8** we get

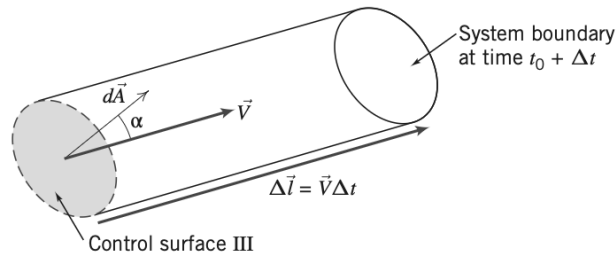
$$\left. \frac{dN}{dt} \right)_s = \lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{(N_{\text{CV}} - N_{\text{I}} + N_{\text{III}})_{t_0 + \Delta t} - N_{\text{CV}}(t_0)}{\Delta t}.$$

Which simplifies to

$$\left. \frac{dN}{dt} \right)_s = \lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{N_{\text{CV}}(t_0 + \Delta t) - N_{\text{CV}}(t_0)}{\Delta t} + \lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{N_{\text{III}}(t_0 + \Delta t)}{\Delta t} - \lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{N_{\text{I}}(t_0 + \Delta t)}{\Delta t}.$$

Each of the three terms can now be evaluated individually. We start with term 1, which simplifies to:

$$\lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{N_{\text{CV}}(t_0 + \Delta t) - N_{\text{CV}}(t_0)}{\Delta t} = \frac{\partial N_{\text{CV}}}{\partial t} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{\text{XC}} \eta \rho dV.$$


 Figure 3.2: Enlarged view of subregion 3 from **Figure 3.1**

To evaluate term 2 we first need develop an expression for $N_{\text{III}})_{t_0+\Delta t}$ by looking at the subregion 3 of region III shown on **Figure 3.2**. The vector area element $d\mathbf{A}$ of the control surface has magnitude dA and its direction is normal outward of the area element. The velocity vector $\mathbf{V}$ will be at some angle α with respect to $d\mathbf{A}$.

For this subregion we have

$$dN_{\text{III}})_{t_0+\Delta t} = (\eta\rho dV)_{t_0+\Delta t}.$$

To obtain an expression for the volume dV of this cylindrical element we first note that its vector length is given by $\Delta\mathbf{l} = \mathbf{V}\Delta t$. Furthermore, the volume of a prismatic cylinder, whose area $d\mathbf{A}$ is at an angle α to its length $\Delta\mathbf{l}$, is given by $dV = \Delta l dA \cos \alpha = \Delta\mathbf{l} \cdot d\mathbf{A}\Delta t$.

Then for the entire region III we can integrate and obtain the second term as:

$$\lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{N_{\text{III}})_{t_0+\Delta t}}{\Delta t} = \lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{\int_{\text{CS}_{\text{III}}} dN_{\text{III}})_{t_0+\Delta t}}{\Delta t} = \int_{\text{CS}_{\text{III}}} \eta\rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

We can perform a similar analysis for subregion 1 of region I and obtain term 3 in the equation as:

$$\lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{N_{\text{I}})_{t_0+\Delta t}}{\Delta t} = - \int_{\text{CS}_{\text{I}}} \eta\rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

For subregion 1 the velocity vector acts into the control volume hence producing a negative scalar product. Hence the minus sign is needed to cancel the negative result of the scalar product.

We can now substitute in the three terms we have found as:

$$\left(\frac{dN}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{\text{CV}} \eta\rho dV + \int_{\text{CS}_{\text{I}}} \eta\rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} + \int_{\text{CS}_{\text{III}}} \eta\rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

As CS_{I} and CS_{III} constitute the entire control surface the last two integrals can be combined as:

$$\left(\frac{dN}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{\text{CV}} \eta\rho dV + \int_{\text{CS}} \eta\rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} \quad (9)$$

Equation 9 is the fundamental relation between the rate of change of any extensive property N of a system and the variations of this property associated with a control volume. This is also called the *Reynolds Transport Theorem*.

Here it is important to note that the system is defined as the matter that happens to be passing through the chosen control volume at the instant we chose. I.e.

- $\left(\frac{dN}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}}$ is the rate of change of the system extensive property N , e.g. if $N = \mathbf{P}$ we obtain the rate of change of momentum
- $\frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{\text{CV}} \eta\rho dV$ is the rate of change of N in the control volume.
- $\int_{\text{CS}} \eta\rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}$ is the rate at which N is exiting the surface of the control volume.

3.2 Conservation of Mass

We remember from subsection 3.1.1 that the mass of the system remains constant,

$$\left(\frac{dM}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}} = 0.$$

If we set $N = M$ and $\eta = 1$ and plug it into Equation 9 we obtain

$$\left. \frac{dM}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \rho dV + \int_{CS} \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

And combining these two gives the control volume formulation of conservation of mass:

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \rho dV + \int_{CS} \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} = 0 \quad (10)$$

3.2.1 Special cases

In some special cases Equation 10 can be simplified. Consider first the case of an incompressible fluid, i.e. ρ is constant in space and time. Consequently Equation 10 can be written as:

$$\rho \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} dV + \rho \int_{CS} \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} = 0.$$

The integral of dV over the control volume is simply the volume, this

$$\frac{\partial V}{\partial t} + \int_{CS} \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} = 0.$$

For a control volume of fixed size and shape, $V = \text{constant}$. The conservation of mass for incompressible flow through a fixed volume becomes:

$$\int_{CS} \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} = 0.$$

A useful special case is when we have uniform velocity at each inlet and exit. In this case it simplifies to

$$\sum_{CS} \mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{A} = 0.$$

We now consider the case of *steady, compressible flow* through a fixed control volume. Since the flow is steady no fluid property varies with time. Consequently the first term of Equation 10 must be zero and hence for steady flow the statement of conservation of mass becomes:

$$\int_{CS} \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} = 0.$$

When we have uniform velocity at each inlet and exit this simplifies to:

$$\sum_{CS} \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{A} = 0.$$

Lecture 4: Control volume analysis II: Momentum & energy equation 3. September 2025

3.3 Momentum Equation for Inertial Control Volume

We will now find a control volume form of Newton's second law. Note that in the following the coordinates (with respect to which velocities are measured) are inertial, i.e. either at rest or moving at a constant speed with respect to an "absolute" set of coordinates.

We have previously defined Newton's second law for a system moving relative to an inertial coordinate system in subsubsection 3.1.2 as:

$$\mathbf{F} = \frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} \bigg|_{\text{system}}$$

where the linear momentum of the system is given by

$$\mathbf{P}_{\text{system}} = \int_{M(\text{system})} \mathbf{V} dm = \int_{V(\text{system})} \mathbf{V} \rho dV$$

and the resultant force $\mathbf{F}$ includes all surface and body forces acting on the system

$$\mathbf{F} = \mathbf{F}_S + \mathbf{F}_B.$$

We have previously derived the relation between the system and control volume formulations in Equation 9 as:

$$\frac{dN}{dt} \bigg|_{\text{system}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \eta \rho dV + \int_{CS} \eta \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

In this we now set $N = \mathbf{P}$ and $\eta = \mathbf{V}$. We thus obtain:

$$\frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} \bigg|_{\text{system}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \mathbf{V} \rho dV + \int_{CS} \mathbf{V} \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

Since in deriving Equation 9 the system and control volume coincided at t_0 , then

$$\mathbf{F})_{\text{on system}} = \mathbf{F})_{\text{on control volume}} = \mathbf{F}_S + \mathbf{F}_B.$$

Now these can be combined as:

$$\mathbf{F} = \mathbf{F}_S + \mathbf{F}_B = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \mathbf{V} \rho dV + \int_{CS} \mathbf{V} \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} \quad (11)$$

For cases with uniform flow at each inlet and exit this becomes:

$$\mathbf{F} = \mathbf{F}_S + \mathbf{F}_B = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \mathbf{V} \rho dV + \sum_{CS} \mathbf{V} \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{A}.$$

When applying Equation 11 we need to be a little careful. First we must choose a control volume and its control surface such that the volume integral and surface integral can be evaluated. In fluid mechanics the body force is usually gravity, so

$$\mathbf{F}_B = \int_{CV} \rho \mathbf{g} dV = \mathbf{W}_{CW} = M\mathbf{g}.$$

In many applications the surface force is due to pressure,

$$\mathbf{F}_S = \int_A -p d\mathbf{A}.$$

The momentum equation in Equation 11 is a vector equation therefore it can be written in three scalar components as:

$$\begin{aligned} F_x &= F_{S_x} + F_{B_x} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} u \rho dV + \int_{CS} u \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} \\ F_y &= F_{S_y} + F_{B_y} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} v \rho dV + \int_{CS} v \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} \\ F_z &= F_{S_z} + F_{B_z} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} w \rho dV + \int_{CS} w \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}. \end{aligned}$$

Or in the case of uniform flow at each inlet and exit as

$$\begin{aligned} F_x &= F_{S_x} + F_{B_x} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} u \rho dV + \sum_{CS} u \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{A} \\ F_y &= F_{S_y} + F_{B_y} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} v \rho dV + \sum_{CS} v \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{A} \\ F_z &= F_{S_z} + F_{B_z} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} w \rho dV + \sum_{CS} w \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{A}. \end{aligned}$$

3.3.1 Differential Control Volume Analysis

The control volume approach that has been presented in the above is useful when applied to a finite region.

If we instead apply the approach to a differential control volume, we can obtain differential equations describing a flow field. Let us apply the continuity and momentum equations to a steady incompressible flow without friction as on Figure 3.3. The control volume is fixed in space and bounded by flow streamlines, and is thus an element of a stream tube. The length of the control volume is ds .

As the control volume is bounded by streamlines, flow across the boundaries of the control volume only happens at the end sections located at coordinates s and $s + ds$. Properties at the inlet sections are assigned arbitrary symbolic values and the properties at the outlet section are assumed to increase by differential amounts.

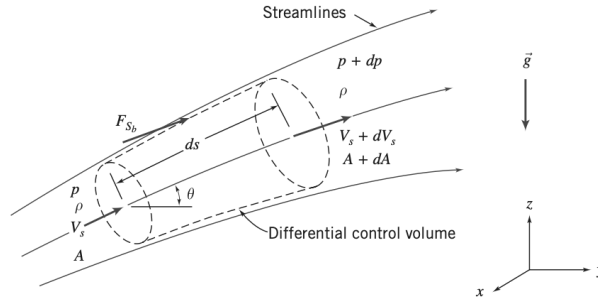


Figure 3.3: Differential control volume through a stream tube.

Now we can apply the continuity equation,

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \rho dV + \int_{CS} \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} = 0.$$

Which under assumptions of steady flow, no flow across the bounding streamlines and that the flow is incompressible ($\rho = \text{constant}$), reduces to:

$$(-\rho V_s A) + (\rho (V_s + dV_s) (A + dA)) = 0 \implies \rho (V_s + dV_s) (A + dA) = \rho V_s A.$$

Simplifying we obtain

$$V_s dA + A dV_s + dA dV_s = 0.$$

The product of the differentials $dA dV_s \approx 0$ compared to the other terms so this can be neglected, leaving us with:

$$V_s dA + A dV_s = 0.$$

Using the streamwise component of the momentum equation we start with:

$$F_{S_s} + F_{B_s} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} u_s \rho dV + \int_{CS} u_s \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

As we assume no friction F_{S_s} is due to pressure forces only, and will thus have three terms:

$$F_{S_s} = pA - (p + dp)(A + dA) + \left(p + \frac{dp}{2}\right) dA.$$

The first and second terms in this are the pressure forces on the end faces of the control surface. The third term is F_{s_b} , the pressure force acting in the s direction on the bounding stream surface. The above equation simplifies to

$$F_{S_s} = -A dp - \frac{1}{2} dp dA.$$

The body force component in the s direction is

$$F_{B_s} = \rho g_s dV = \rho (-g \sin \theta) \left(A + \frac{dA}{2}\right) ds.$$

But $\sin \theta ds = dz$ so

$$F_{B_s} = -\rho g \left(A + \frac{dA}{2}\right) dz.$$

The momentum flux will be

$$\int_{CS} u_s \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} = V_s (-\rho V_s A) + (V_s + dV_s) (\rho (V_s + dV_s) (A + dA)).$$

The two mass flux factors are equal from continuity so

$$\int_{CS} u_s \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} = V_s (-\rho V_s A) + (V_s + dV_s) (\rho V_s A) = \rho V_s A dV_s.$$

Substituting all of these into the momentum equation yields

$$-A dp - \frac{1}{2} dp dA - \rho g A dz - \frac{1}{2} \rho g dA dz = \rho V_s A dV_s.$$

Dividing by ρA and noting that products of differentials are negligible we obtain:

$$-\frac{dp}{\rho} - g dz = V_s dV_s = d\left(\frac{V_s^2}{2}\right)$$

or

$$\frac{dp}{\rho} + d\left(\frac{V_s^2}{2}\right) + g dz = 0.$$

As the flow is incompressible and $\rho = \text{constant}$ we can integrate this to obtain:

$$\frac{p}{\rho} + \frac{V_s^2}{2} + gz = \text{constant}.$$

This is one form of the Bernoulli equation and it is only valid under the following restrictions:

1. Steady flow
2. No friction
3. Flow along a streamline
4. Incompressible flow

3.4 Momentum equation for Control Volume with Rectilinear Acceleration

To develop the momentum equation for a linearly accelerating control volume, it is necessary to relate $\mathbf{P}_{XYZ}$ to $\mathbf{P}_{xyz}$. We begin by writing Newton's second law for a system, remembering the acceleration must be measured relative to an inertial reference frame that we have designated XYZ . We get

$$\mathbf{F} = \frac{d\mathbf{P}_{XYZ}}{dt} \bigg|_{\text{system}} = \frac{d}{dt} \int_{M(\text{system})} \mathbf{V}_{XYZ} dm = \int_{M(\text{system})} \frac{d\mathbf{V}_{XYZ}}{dt} dm.$$

The velocities with respect to the inertial (XYZ) and the control volume coordinates (xyz) are related by the relative-motion equation:

$$\mathbf{V}_{XYZ} = \mathbf{V}_{xyz} + \mathbf{V}_{rf}$$

where $\mathbf{V}_{rf}$ is the velocity of the control volume coordinates xyz with respect to the absolute XYZ .

We assume the motion of xyz is purely translational relative to the inertial reference frame XYZ , so:

$$\frac{d\mathbf{V}_{XYZ}}{dt} = \mathbf{a}_{XYZ} = \frac{d\mathbf{V}_{xyz}}{dt} + \frac{d\mathbf{V}_{rf}}{dt} = \mathbf{a}_{xyz} + \mathbf{a}_{rf}.$$

Substituting this into Newton's second law from above we get:

$$\mathbf{F} = \int_{M(\text{system})} \mathbf{a}_{rf} dm + \int_{M(\text{system})} \frac{d\mathbf{V}_{xyz}}{dt} dm$$

or

$$\mathbf{F} - \int_{M(\text{system})} \mathbf{a}_{rf} dm = \frac{d\mathbf{P}_{xyz}}{dt} \bigg|_{\text{system}}$$

where the linear momentum of the system is

$$\mathbf{P}_{xyz})_{\text{system}} = \int_{M(\text{system})} \mathbf{V}_{xyz} dm = \int_{V(\text{system})} \mathbf{V}_{xyz} \rho dV$$

and the force $\mathbf{F}$ includes all surface and body forces that are acting on the system.

To derive the control volume formulation of Newton's second law, we set $N = \mathbf{P}_{xyz}$ and $\eta = \mathbf{V}_{xyz}$. Substituting this into Equation 9 we obtain:

$$\frac{d\mathbf{P}_{xyz}}{dt} \bigg|_{\text{system}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \mathbf{V}_{xyz} \rho dV + \int_{CS} \mathbf{V}_{xyz} \rho \mathbf{V}_{xyz} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

If we combine this with the linear momentum equation for the system we obtain:

$$\mathbf{F} - \int_{CV} \mathbf{a}_{rf} \rho dV = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \mathbf{V}_{xyz} \rho dV + \int_{CS} \mathbf{V}_{xyz} \rho \mathbf{V}_{xyz} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

And since $\mathbf{F} = \mathbf{F}_S + \mathbf{F}_B$ this becomes

$$\mathbf{F}_S + \mathbf{F}_B - \int_{CV} \mathbf{a}_{rf} \rho dV = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \mathbf{V}_{xyz} \rho dV + \int_{CS} \mathbf{V}_{xyz} \rho \mathbf{V}_{xyz} \cdot d\mathbf{A} \quad (12)$$

Comparing Equation 12 to that for a non-accelerating control volume we see that they only differ by the introduction of the term $-\int_{CV} \mathbf{a}_{rf} \rho dV$, and for a non-accelerating reference frame $\mathbf{a}_{rf} = 0$ and it reduces to the equation for a non-accelerating reference frame.

This can also be written in components as:

$$\begin{aligned} F_{S_x} + F_{B_x} - \int_{CV} a_{rf_x} \rho dV &= \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} u_{xyz} \rho dV + \int_{CS} u_{xyz} \rho \mathbf{V}_{xyz} \cdot d\mathbf{A} \\ F_{S_y} + F_{B_y} - \int_{CV} a_{rf_y} \rho dV &= \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} v_{xyz} \rho dV + \int_{CS} v_{xyz} \rho \mathbf{V}_{xyz} \cdot d\mathbf{A} \\ F_{S_z} + F_{B_z} - \int_{CV} a_{rf_z} \rho dV &= \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} w_{xyz} \rho dV + \int_{CS} w_{xyz} \rho \mathbf{V}_{xyz} \cdot d\mathbf{A}. \end{aligned}$$

3.5 The Angular-Momentum Principle

3.5.1 Equation for Fixed Control Volume

The angular-momentum principle for a system in an inertial frame is

$$\mathbf{T} = \left. \frac{d\mathbf{H}}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}}$$

where $\mathbf{T}$ is the total torque exerted on the system by its surroundings and $\mathbf{H}$ is the angular momentum of the system.

$$\mathbf{H} = \int_{M(\text{system})} \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{V} dm = \int_{V(\text{system})} \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{V} \rho dV.$$

If we let $\mathbf{r}$ locate each mass or volume element of the system with respect to the coordinate system, then the torque $\mathbf{T}$ applied to the system may be written:

$$\mathbf{T} = \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{F}_s + \int_{M(\text{system})} \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{g} dm + \mathbf{T}_{\text{shaft}}.$$

The relation between the system and fixed control volume formulation is

$$\left. \frac{dN}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \eta \rho dV + \int_{CS} \eta \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

where $N_{\text{system}} = \int_{M(\text{system})} \eta dm$. If we set $N = \mathbf{H}$ and $\eta = \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{V}$ then:

$$\left. \frac{d\mathbf{H}}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{V} \rho dV + \int_{CS} \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{V} \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

Combining these we obtain:

$$\mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{F}_s + \int_{M(\text{system})} \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{g} dm + \mathbf{T}_{\text{shaft}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{V} \rho dV + \int_{CS} \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{V} \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

Since the system and control volume coincide at t_0 we have that $\mathbf{T} = \mathbf{T}_{CV}$ and therefore:

$$\mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{F}_s + \int_{CV} \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{g} \rho dV + \mathbf{T}_{\text{shaft}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{V} \rho dV + \int_{CS} \mathbf{r} \times \mathbf{V} \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

3.6 The First Law of Thermodynamics

We recall the system formulation of the first law of thermodynamics was

$$\dot{Q} - \dot{W} = \frac{dE}{dt} \Big|_{\text{system}}$$

where the total energy of the system is given by

$$E_{\text{system}} = \int_{M(\text{system})} e \, dm = \int_{V(\text{system})} e \rho \, dV$$

and

$$e = u + \frac{V^2}{2} + gz.$$

We set $N = E$ and $\eta = e$ in Equation 9 and obtain:

$$\frac{dE}{dt} \Big|_{\text{system}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} e \rho \, dV + \int_{CS} e \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

Since the system and control volume coincide at t_0 we have that $\left[\dot{Q} - \dot{W} \right]_{\text{system}} = \left[\dot{Q} - \dot{W} \right]_{\text{control volume}}$. In light of this we get the control volume form of the first law of thermodynamics as:

$$\dot{Q} - \dot{W} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} e \rho \, dV + \int_{CS} e \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} \quad (13)$$

where

$$e = u + \frac{V^2}{2} + gz.$$

Note that for steady flow the right hand side of Equation 13 is zero.

3.6.1 Rate of Work Done by a Control Volume

The rate of work done by a control volume is subdivided into four classifications,

$$\dot{W} = \dot{W}_s + \dot{W}_{\text{normal}} + \dot{W}_{\text{shear}} + \dot{W}_{\text{other}}.$$

Shaft Work We will designate the shaft work W_s and hence the rate of work transferred out through the control system by shaft work is designated $\dot{W}_s$.

Work Done by Normal Stresses at the Control Surface Work requires a force to act through a distance. Thus, when a force $\mathbf{F}$ acts through an infinitesimal displacement $d\mathbf{s}$ the work done is given by

$$\delta W = \mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s}.$$

If we divide this by the time increment Δt and take the limit as $\Delta t \rightarrow 0$ we obtain the rate of work done by the force $\mathbf{F}$ as:

$$\dot{W} = \lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{\delta W}{\Delta t} = \lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{\mathbf{F} \cdot d\mathbf{s}}{\Delta t} \implies \dot{W} = \mathbf{F} \cdot \mathbf{V}.$$

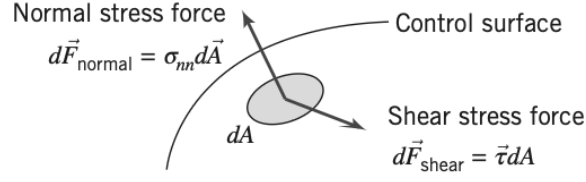


Figure 3.4: Normal and shear stress forces.

We can use this to compute the rate of work done by normal and shear stresses. We consider the segment of control surface shown on Figure 3.4. For an element of area $d\mathbf{A}$ we can write an expression for the normal stress force $d\mathbf{F}_{\text{normal}}$. This will be given by the normal stress σ_{nn} multiplied by the vector element $d\mathbf{A}$. Hence:

$$d\mathbf{F}_{\text{normal}} \cdot \mathbf{V} = \sigma_{nn} d\mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{V}.$$

Since the work out from the control volume is the negative work done on the control volume we get:

$$\dot{W}_{\text{normal}} = - \int_{\text{CS}} \sigma_{nn} d\mathbf{A} \cdot \mathbf{V} = - \int_{\text{CS}} \sigma_{nn} \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

Work Done by Shear Stresses at the Control Surface As shown on Figure 3.4 the shear force acting on an element of the control surface is given by:

$$d\mathbf{F}_{\text{shear}} = \boldsymbol{\tau} dA$$

where the shear stress vector, $\boldsymbol{\tau}$, is the shear stress acting in some direction in the plane of dA . The rate of work done on the entire control surface by shear stresses is thus:

$$\int_{\text{CS}} \boldsymbol{\tau} dA \cdot \mathbf{V} = \int_{\text{CS}} \boldsymbol{\tau} \cdot \mathbf{V} dA.$$

Since the work out from the control volume is the negative of the work done on the control volume we get:

$$\dot{W}_{\text{shear}} = - \int_{\text{CS}} \boldsymbol{\tau} \cdot \mathbf{V} dA.$$

This is better expressed as three terms:

$$\dot{W}_{\text{shear}} = - \int_{\text{CS}} \boldsymbol{\tau} \cdot \mathbf{V} dA = - \int_{A(\text{shafts})} \boldsymbol{\tau} \cdot \mathbf{V} dA - \int_{A(\text{solid surface})} \boldsymbol{\tau} \cdot \mathbf{V} dA - \int_{A(\text{ports})} \boldsymbol{\tau} \cdot \mathbf{V} dA.$$

We have already accounted for the first term as $\dot{W}_s$ previously. At solid surfaces, $\mathbf{V} = 0$, so the second term is zero (for a fixed control volume). Thus

$$\dot{W}_{\text{shear}} = - \int_{A(\text{ports})} \boldsymbol{\tau} \cdot \mathbf{V} dA.$$

For a control surface perpendicular to $\mathbf{V}$ we get $\boldsymbol{\tau} \cdot \mathbf{V} = 0$ and therefore $\dot{W}_{\text{shear}} = 0$.

Other Work This includes electrical and electromagnetic energy that could be absorbed by the control volume. This is absent in most cases, but for the general formulation it must be included.

With all terms in $\dot{W}$ evaluated, we get:

$$\dot{W} = \dot{W}_s - \int_{CS} \sigma_{nn} \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} + \dot{W}_{\text{shear}} + \dot{W}_{\text{other}}.$$

Substituting this into the original expression we get:

$$\dot{Q} - \dot{W}_s + \int_{CS} \sigma_{nn} \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} - \dot{W}_{\text{shear}} - \dot{W}_{\text{other}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} e \rho dV + \int_{CS} e \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

Rearranging this and remembering $\rho = \frac{1}{v}$, where v is specific volume we get:

$$\dot{Q} - \dot{W}_s - \dot{W}_{\text{shear}} - \dot{W}_{\text{other}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} e \rho dV + \int_{CS} (e + \rho v) \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

Substituting $e = u + \frac{V^2}{2} + gz$ into the last term we obtain the first law of thermodynamics for a control volume as:

$$\dot{Q} - \dot{W}_s - \dot{W}_{\text{shear}} - \dot{W}_{\text{other}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} e \rho dV + \int_{CS} \left(u + pv + \frac{V^2}{2} + gz \right) \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

3.6.2 The Second Law of Thermodynamics

The second law of thermodynamics applies to all fluid systems and is formulated as:

$$\left(\frac{dS}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}} \geq \frac{1}{T} \dot{Q}$$

where the total entropy of the system is given by

$$S_{\text{system}} = \int_{M(\text{system})} s dm = \int_{V(\text{system})} s \rho dV.$$

We set $N = S$ and $\eta = s$ in Equation 9 and obtain

$$\left(\frac{dS}{dt} \right)_{\text{system}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} s \rho dV + \int_{CS} s \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}.$$

As the system and control volume coincide at t_0 we have that

$$\frac{1}{T} \dot{Q}_{\text{system}} = \frac{1}{T} \dot{Q}_{CV} = \int_{CS} \frac{1}{T} \left(\frac{\dot{Q}}{A} \right) dA.$$

Thus the control volume formulation of the second law of thermodynamics is:

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} s \rho dV + \int_{CS} s \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} \geq \int_{CS} \frac{1}{T} \left(\frac{\dot{Q}}{A} \right) dA.$$

Here the factor $\frac{\dot{Q}}{A}$ represents the heat flux per unit area into the control volume through the area element dA . To evaluate the term

$$\int_{CS} \frac{1}{T} \left(\frac{\dot{Q}}{A} \right) dA.$$

both the local heat flux and local temperature T must be known for each area element of the control surface.

Lecture 5: Differential Analysis I: Mass conservation

8. September 2025

4 Introduction to Differential Analysis of Fluid Motion

In the previous section 3 the basic equations in integral form for a control volume were introduced. These are useful when we are interested in the overall behaviour of a fluid field and its effects on its surroundings. To determine what happens at each point of the flow field we must use the differential forms of the equations of motion.

4.1 Conservation of Mass

4.1.1 Rectangular Coordinate System

To find the differential equation for conservation of mass in a rectangular coordinate system we choose a control volume that is an infinitesimal cube with sides of length dx, dy, dz as shown on Figure 4.1. The density at the center, O , of the control volume is assumed to be ρ and the velocity there is assumed to be $\mathbf{V} = \hat{i}u + \hat{j}v + \hat{k}w$.

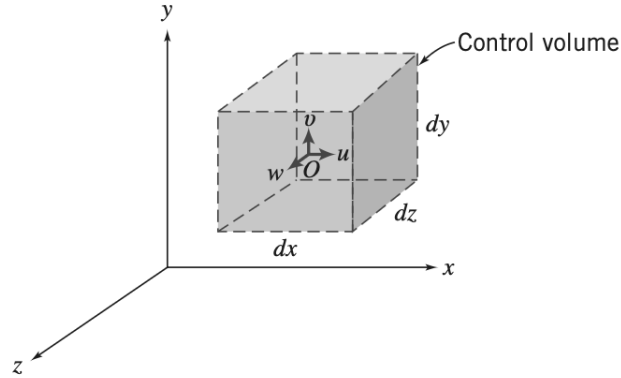


Figure 4.1: Differential control volume in rectangular coordinates.

Now, to evaluate the properties at each of the six faces of the control series we will use a Taylor series expansion about point O . E.g. for the right face:

$$\rho)_{x+\frac{dx}{2}} = \rho + \left(\frac{\partial \rho}{\partial x}\right) \frac{dx}{2} + \left(\frac{\partial^2 \rho}{\partial x^2}\right) \frac{1}{2!} \left(\frac{dx}{2}\right)^2 + \dots$$

By neglecting higher-order terms, we can write:

$$\rho)_{x+\frac{dx}{2}} = \rho + \left(\frac{\partial \rho}{\partial x}\right) \frac{dx}{2}.$$

Likewise for the velocity we can write:

$$u)_{x+\frac{dx}{2}} = u + \left(\frac{\partial u}{\partial x}\right) \frac{dx}{2}$$

where ρ , u , $\frac{\partial p}{\partial x}$, and $\frac{\partial u}{\partial x}$ are all evaluated at point O . Following the same procedure for the left hand side we get:

$$\begin{aligned}\rho)_{x-\frac{dx}{2}} &= \rho - \left(\frac{\partial \rho}{\partial x}\right) \frac{dx}{2} \\ u)_{x-\frac{dx}{2}} &= u - \left(\frac{\partial u}{\partial x}\right) \frac{dx}{2}.\end{aligned}$$

Similar expressions for ρ and v for the front and back faces and ρ and w for the top and bottom faces of the infinitesimal control volume can be made. These can then be used to evaluate the surface integral in Equation 10 (i.e. we can find the net flux of mass out of the control volume). Equation 10 states

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \rho dV + \int_{CS} \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} = 0.$$

If we assume that the velocity components u , v , and w are positive in the x , y , and z directions, respectively, that the area normal is positive out of the cube and that higher order terms can be neglected as we find the limit of dx , dy , and dz as they go to zero, then we can solve the surface integral to be:

$$\int_{CS} \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A} = \left(\frac{\partial \rho u}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial \rho v}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial \rho w}{\partial z} \right) dx dy dz.$$

To complete Equation 10 we need to evaluate the volume integral:

$$\frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{CV} \rho dV = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} (\rho dx dy dz) = \frac{\partial \rho}{\partial t} dx dy dz.$$

Hence we obtain the differential form of the mass conservation law:

$$\frac{\partial \rho u}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial \rho v}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial \rho w}{\partial z} + \frac{\partial \rho}{\partial t} = 0 \quad (14)$$

Equation 14 is often called the *continuity equation*.

Since ∇ is given by:

$$\nabla = \hat{i} \frac{\partial}{\partial x} + \hat{j} \frac{\partial}{\partial y} + \hat{k} \frac{\partial}{\partial z}$$

then

$$\frac{\partial \rho u}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial \rho v}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial \rho w}{\partial z} = \nabla \cdot \rho \mathbf{V}.$$

Therefore the conservation of mass from Equation 14 can also be written as:

$$\nabla \cdot \rho \mathbf{V} + \frac{\partial \rho}{\partial t} = 0 \quad (15)$$

When Equation 14 is written on vector form as in Equation 15 it may be applied in any coordinate system – even a cylindrical or polar one.

Two special cases of the continuity equation are worth a mention.

4.1.2 Incompressible Fluid

For an incompressible fluid $\rho = \text{constant}$ and is therefore neither a function of space coordinate nor time. Therefore the continuity equation for an incompressible fluid simplifies to:

$$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{V} = 0.$$

Thus the velocity field, $\mathbf{V}(x, y, z, t)$ must satisfy $\nabla \cdot \mathbf{V} = 0$ for an incompressible fluid.

4.1.3 Steady Flow

For steady flow, all fluid properties, are, by definition, independent of time. This for steady flow the continuity equation simplifies to:

$$\nabla \cdot \rho \mathbf{V} = 0.$$

4.2 Stream Function for Two-Dimensional Incompressible Flow

Streamlines have previously been defined as being lines tangent to the velocity vectors in a flow at an instant:

$$\left. \frac{dy}{dx} \right|_{\text{streamline}} = \frac{v}{u}.$$

We will now seek to develop a more formal definition of stream lines by introducing the *stream function* ψ . This function allows us to represent two entities – the velocity components $u(x, y, t)$ and $v(x, y, t)$ of a two-dimensional incompressible flow – with a single function $\psi(x, y, t)$.

We start with a two-dimensional version of the continuity equation for incompressible flow:

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial v}{\partial y} = 0 \quad (16)$$

We now define the stream function by:

$$u \equiv \frac{\partial \psi}{\partial y} \quad \text{and} \quad v \equiv -\frac{\partial \psi}{\partial x}.$$

By doing this Equation 16 is automatically satisfied for any $\psi(x, y, t)$. Using the “naive” definition of streamlines introduced at the beginning of this section we can obtain an equation that is only valid along a streamline:

$$u \, dy - v \, dx = 0$$

or using the stream function

$$\frac{\partial \psi}{\partial x} \, dx + \frac{\partial \psi}{\partial y} \, dy = 0 \quad (17)$$

From a strictly mathematical point of view, at any instant in time t the variation in a function $\psi(x, y, t)$ in space (x, y) is given by;

$$d\psi = \frac{\partial \psi}{\partial x} \, dx + \frac{\partial \psi}{\partial y} \, dy \quad (18)$$

Comparing Equation 17 and Equation 18 we see that along an instantaneous streamline $d\psi = 0$, i.e. ψ is constant along a streamline. Therefore we can specify individual streamlines by their stream function values $\psi = 0, 1, 2, \dots$. Furthermore, these ψ values can be used to obtain the volume flow rate between any two streamlines. Consider the streamlines shown on Figure 4.2. We can compute the volume flow rate between ψ_1 and ψ_2 by using line AB , BC , DE , or EF (remember there is no flow across a streamline).

Now let us compare the volume flow rate found using line AB and line BC – these should be the same.

For a unit depth, the flow rate across AB is

$$Q = \int_{y_1}^{y_2} u \, dy = \int_{y_1}^{y_2} \frac{\partial \psi}{\partial y} \, dy.$$

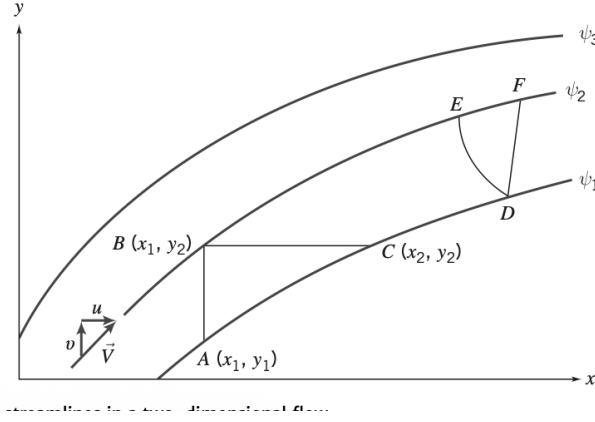


Figure 4.2: Instantaneous streamlines in a two-dimensional flow

Along AB , $x = \text{constant}$, thus

$$d\psi = \frac{\partial\psi}{\partial y} dy$$

therefore:

$$Q = \int_{y_1}^{y_2} \frac{\partial\psi}{\partial y} dy = \int_{\psi_1}^{\psi_2} d\psi = \psi_2 - \psi_1.$$

The same procedure is followed for BC , however here $y = \text{constant}$, thus:

$$\begin{aligned} Q &= \int_{x_1}^{x_2} v dx \\ &= - \int_{x_1}^{x_2} \frac{\partial\psi}{\partial x} dx \\ &= - \int_{\psi_2}^{\psi_1} d\psi = \psi_2 - \psi_1. \end{aligned}$$

Hence the volume flow rate per unit depth between two streamlines is given by the difference between the stream function values.

For two-dimensional steady compressible flow in the xy plane, the stream function ψ can be defined such that:

$$\rho u \equiv \frac{\partial\psi}{\partial y} \quad \text{and} \quad \rho v \equiv -\frac{\partial\psi}{\partial x}.$$

Then the difference between the constant values of ψ defining two streamlines is the mass flow rate per unit depth between the two streamlines.

If $\psi = 0$ is used to designate the streamline through the origin, the all other ψ values for all other streamlines represents the flow between the origin and that streamline.

Lecture 6: Differential Analysis II: Kinematics & Navier-Stokes equations 10. September 2025**4.3 Motion of a Fluid Particle (Kinematics)**

On Figure 4.3 a typical finite fluid element is shown. Within this an infinitesimal particle with mass dm and initial volume $dx\,dy\,dz$, at time t as well as how it may look after an infinitesimal time interval dt . After this period the finite element has moved and changed its shape. We will examine the infinitesimal particle so that we eventually obtain results applicable to a point. We can decompose this infinitesimal particle's motion into four components:

- translation, where the particle moves from one point to another
- rotation, which can occur about any or all of the x , y or z axes
- linear deformation, in which the particle's sides stretch or contract
- angular deformation, in which angles that were initially 90° between the sides of the particle changes

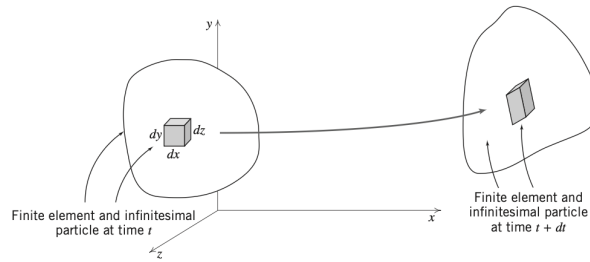


Figure 4.3: Finite fluid element and infinitesimal particle at times t and $t + dt$

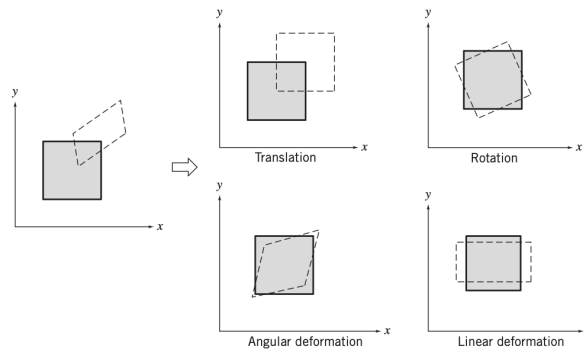


Figure 4.4: Pictorial representation of the components of fluid motion.

4.3.1 Fluid Translation: Acceleration of a Fluid Particle in a Velocity Field

We will need the acceleration of a fluid particle to be able to apply Newton's second law to it.

Consider a particle moving in a velocity field. At time, t , the particle is in position x, y, z and has a velocity vector corresponding to the velocity at that point in space at time t ,

$$\left. \mathbf{V}_P \right]_t = \mathbf{V}(x, y, z, t).$$

At time $t + dt$ the particle has moved to a new position with coordinates $x + dx, y + dy, z + dz$ and its velocity will when be given by

$$\left. \mathbf{V}_P \right]_{t+dt} = \mathbf{V}(x + dx, y + dy, z + dz, t + dt).$$

If the particle velocity at time t (position $\mathbf{r}$) is given by $\mathbf{V}_P = \mathbf{V}(x, y, z, t)$, then $d\mathbf{V}_p$ is given by the chain rule as:

$$d\mathbf{V}_p = \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial x} dx_p + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial y} dy_p + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial z} dz_p + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial t} dt.$$

The total acceleration of the particle is given by:

$$\mathbf{a}_p = \frac{d\mathbf{V}_p}{dt} = \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial x} \frac{dx_p}{dt} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial y} \frac{dy_p}{dt} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial z} \frac{dz_p}{dt} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial t}.$$

And since

$$\frac{dx_p}{dt} = u, \quad \frac{dy_p}{dt} = v, \quad \frac{dz_p}{dt} = w$$

we have

$$\mathbf{a}_p = \frac{d\mathbf{V}_p}{dt} = u \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial z} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial t}.$$

A special symbol $\frac{D\mathbf{V}}{Dt}$ is given to the derivative to remind us that it is not simply a normal derivative, thus:

$$\frac{D\mathbf{V}}{Dt} \equiv \mathbf{a}_p = u \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial z} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial t}.$$

This derivative is sometimes called the *substantial derivative*, the *material derivative* or the *particle derivative*.

From this we see that a fluid particle moving in a flow field may accelerate for either of two reasons. Either through *convective acceleration*, where fluid particles are *convected* between regions with different velocities. If the flow field is unsteady an additional *local acceleration* is applied, because the velocity field is then a function of time.

The convective acceleration can be written using the gradient operator as:

$$u \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial z} = (\mathbf{V} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{V}.$$

Thus the acceleration may be written as:

$$\frac{D\mathbf{V}}{Dt} \equiv \mathbf{a}_p = (\mathbf{V} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{V} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial t}.$$

For a two dimensional flow, this becomes:

$$\frac{D\mathbf{V}}{Dt} = u \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial t}.$$

For a one dimensional flow it becomes:

$$\frac{D\mathbf{V}}{Dt} = u \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial z}.$$

And finally for a steady flow in three dimensions it becomes:

$$\frac{D\mathbf{V}}{Dt} = u \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial z}.$$

This means that a fluid particle may undergo convective acceleration even in a steady velocity field simply due to its motion. As scalar component equation we have

$$\begin{aligned} a_{x_p} &= \frac{Du}{Dt} = u \frac{\partial u}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial u}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial u}{\partial z} + \frac{\partial u}{\partial t} \\ a_{y_p} &= \frac{Dv}{Dt} = u \frac{\partial v}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial v}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial v}{\partial z} + \frac{\partial v}{\partial t} \\ a_{z_p} &= \frac{Dw}{Dt} = u \frac{\partial w}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial w}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial w}{\partial z} + \frac{\partial w}{\partial t}. \end{aligned}$$

4.3.2 Fluid Rotation

The fluid particle may rotate about all coordinate axes. In general,

$$\boldsymbol{\omega} = \hat{i}\omega_x + \hat{j}\omega_y + \hat{k}\omega_z.$$

We now consider the xy plane view of the particle at time t on Figure 4.5. The left and lower sides of the particle are given by the two perpendicular line segments oa and ob of length Δx and Δy , respectively. After a time interval Δt the particle will have translated to some new position and also have rotated and deformed.

These two sides may now have deformed by the same angle $\Delta\alpha$ and $\Delta\beta$. To extract a rotation from this one takes the average of the rotations of $\Delta\alpha$ and $\Delta\beta$ such that the counterclockwise rotation is $\frac{1}{2}(\Delta\alpha - \Delta\beta)$.

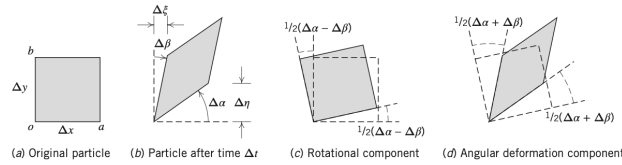


Figure 4.5: Rotation and angular deformation of perpendicular line segments in a two-dimensional flow.

From $\Delta\alpha$ and $\Delta\beta$ we can also determine a measure of the particle's angular deformation. To obtain the deformation of side oa we subtract the particle rotation $\frac{1}{2}(\Delta\alpha - \Delta\beta)$ from the actual rotation of oa , $\Delta\alpha$, what remains is the deformation of side oa . The total deformation of the particle is the sum of the deformations of the sides or $\Delta\alpha + \Delta\beta$.

Now we need to convert these angular measures to quantities obtainable from the flow field. To do this, we recognize that for small angles $\Delta\alpha = \frac{\Delta\eta}{\Delta x}$, and $\Delta\beta = \frac{\Delta\xi}{\Delta y}$. $\Delta\xi$ arises because, if in an interval Δt point o moves horizontally distance $u\Delta t$ then point b will have moved a distance $\left(u + \left(\frac{\partial u}{\partial y}\right)\Delta y\right)\Delta t$. Likewise for $\Delta\eta$. Hence,

$$\begin{aligned} \Delta\xi &= \left(u + \frac{\partial u}{\partial y}\Delta y\right)\Delta t - u\Delta t = \frac{\partial u}{\partial y}\Delta y\Delta t \\ \Delta\eta &= \left(v + \frac{\partial v}{\partial x}\Delta x\right)\Delta t - v\Delta t = \frac{\partial v}{\partial x}\Delta x\Delta t. \end{aligned}$$

We can now compute the angular velocity of the particle about the z axis ω_z by combining all these results:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \omega_z &= \lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{1}{2}(\Delta\alpha - \Delta\beta)}{\Delta t} \\
 &= \lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{1}{2}\left(\frac{\Delta\eta}{\Delta x} - \frac{\Delta\xi}{\Delta y}\right)}{\Delta t} \\
 &= \lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{1}{2}\left(\frac{\partial v}{\partial x} \frac{\Delta x}{\Delta x} \Delta t - \frac{\partial u}{\partial y} \frac{\Delta y}{\Delta y} \Delta t\right)}{\Delta t} \\
 &= \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{\partial v}{\partial x} - \frac{\partial u}{\partial y} \right).
 \end{aligned}$$

Similarly one can show that:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \omega_x &= \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{\partial w}{\partial y} - \frac{\partial v}{\partial z} \right) \\
 \omega_y &= \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{\partial u}{\partial z} - \frac{\partial w}{\partial x} \right).
 \end{aligned}$$

Then $\boldsymbol{\omega}$ becomes:

$$\boldsymbol{\omega} = \frac{1}{2} \left(\hat{i} \left(\frac{\partial w}{\partial y} - \frac{\partial v}{\partial z} \right) + \hat{j} \left(\frac{\partial u}{\partial z} - \frac{\partial w}{\partial x} \right) + \hat{k} \left(\frac{\partial v}{\partial x} - \frac{\partial u}{\partial y} \right) \right).$$

The term in the outermost parenthesis can be written

$$\text{curl} \mathbf{V} = \nabla \times \mathbf{V}.$$

And therefore we get:

$$\boldsymbol{\omega} = \frac{1}{2} \nabla \times \mathbf{V}.$$

Fluid rotation can arise in a number of different ways. One way, if the particles are not rotating initially, for rotation to be induced is due to torque caused by surface shear stresses – the particle body force and pressure forces cannot generate torque. Hence rotation of fluid particles will always occur when we have shear stresses.

Flows without particle rotation are called *irrotational flows*. Although no real flow is truly irrotational as all fluids are viscous, many flows can be studied assuming they are inviscid and irrotational.

The factor of $\frac{1}{2}$ can be eliminated in the expression for $\boldsymbol{\omega}$ by defining the vorticity $\boldsymbol{\xi}$ to be twice the rotation,

$$\boldsymbol{\xi} \equiv 2\boldsymbol{\omega} = \nabla \times \mathbf{V}.$$

The *circulation*, Γ , is defined as the line integral of the tangential velocity component about any closed curve fixed in the flow,

$$\Gamma = \oint_c \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{s}$$

where $d\mathbf{s}$ is an elemental vector tangent to the curve with length ds of the element of arc. We can develop a relationship between circulation and vorticity by considering the rectangular circuit shown in Figure 4.6, where the velocity components at o are set to (u, v) and the velocities along segments bc and ac can be derived using Taylor series approximations.

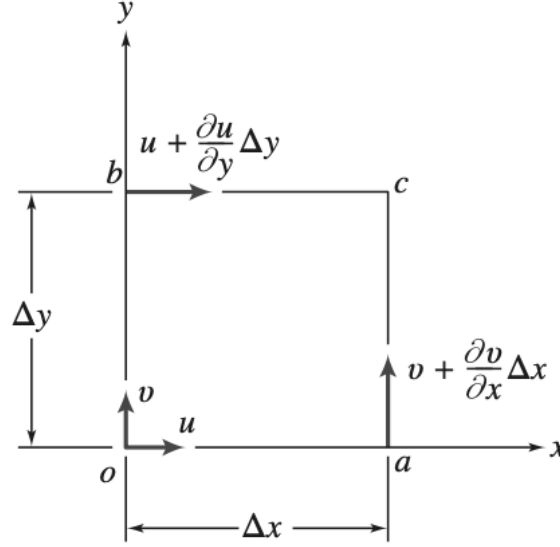


Figure 4.6: Velocity components on the boundaries of a fluid element.

For the closed curve $oacb$ we get

$$\begin{aligned}\Delta\Gamma &= u\Delta x + \left(v + \frac{\partial v}{\partial x}\Delta x\right)\Delta y - \left(u + \frac{\partial u}{\partial y}\Delta y\right)\Delta x - v\Delta y \\ &= \left(\frac{\partial v}{\partial x} - \frac{\partial u}{\partial y}\right)\Delta x\Delta y \\ &= 2\omega_z\Delta x\Delta y.\end{aligned}$$

Then

$$\Gamma = \oint_c \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{s} = \int_A 2\omega_z dA = \int_A (\nabla \times \mathbf{V})_z dA \quad (19)$$

Equation 19 is a statement of the Stokes theorem in two dimensions; the circulation around a closed contour is equal to the total vorticity enclosed within it.

4.3.3 Fluid Deformation

Angular Deformation The total angular deformation of a particle is given by the sum of the two angular deformations, i.e. $\Delta\alpha + \Delta\beta$. We have also found $\Delta\alpha = \frac{\Delta\eta}{\Delta x}$, $\Delta\beta = \frac{\Delta\xi}{\Delta y}$ where $\Delta\xi$ and $\Delta\eta$ are given by

$$\begin{aligned}\Delta\xi &= \left(u + \frac{\partial u}{\partial y}\Delta y\right)\Delta t - u\Delta t = \frac{\partial u}{\partial y}\Delta y\Delta t \\ \Delta\eta &= \left(v + \frac{\partial v}{\partial x}\Delta x\right)\Delta t - v\Delta t = \frac{\partial v}{\partial x}\Delta x\Delta t.\end{aligned}$$

By combining these results we can compute the rate of angular deformation of the particle in the xy as

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{Rate of angular deformation}_{xy} &= \lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{(\Delta\alpha + \Delta\beta)}{\Delta t} \\
 &= \lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{\Delta\eta}{\Delta x} + \frac{\Delta\xi}{\Delta y}}{\Delta t} \\
 &= \lim_{\Delta t \rightarrow 0} \frac{\frac{\partial v}{\partial x} \frac{\Delta x}{\Delta x} \Delta t + \frac{\partial u}{\partial y} \frac{\Delta y}{\Delta y} \Delta t}{\Delta t} \\
 &= \frac{\partial v}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial u}{\partial y}.
 \end{aligned}$$

Similar expressions can be found for the angular deformation in the yz and zx planes:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{Rate of angular deformation}_{yz} &= \frac{\partial w}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial v}{\partial z} \\
 \text{Rate of angular deformation}_{zx} &= \frac{\partial w}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial u}{\partial z}.
 \end{aligned}$$

We have previously shown that for one-dimensional laminar Newtonian flow the shear stress is given by the rate of deformation of the particle:

$$\tau_{yx} = \mu \frac{du}{dy}.$$

This is a special case of the expression derived above.

Linear Deformation During linear deformation, the shape of the fluid element, described by the angles at its vertices, is unchanged. The element will change length in the x direction only if $\frac{\partial u}{\partial x} \neq 0$, similarly a change in the y and z directions only happens for $\frac{\partial v}{\partial y} \neq 0$ and $\frac{\partial w}{\partial z} \neq 0$ respectively.

The rate of local instantaneous *volume dilation* is

$$\text{Volume dilation rate} = \frac{\partial u}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial v}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial w}{\partial z} = \nabla \cdot \mathbf{V}.$$

For incompressible flow, the rate of volume dilation is zero.

4.4 Momentum Equation

A dynamic equation describing the motion of a fluid may be obtained by applying Newton's second law to a particle. To derive the differential form of the momentum equation, we shall apply Newton's second law to an infinitesimal fluid particle of mass dm .

Newton's second law for a finite system is

$$\mathbf{F} = \frac{d\mathbf{P}}{dt} \bigg|_{\text{system}}$$

where the linear momentum $\mathbf{P}$ of the system is given by

$$\mathbf{P}_{\text{system}} = \int_{\text{mass(system)}} \mathbf{V} dm.$$

For an infinitesimal system of mass dm this law can be written as:

$$d\mathbf{F} = dm \frac{d\mathbf{V}}{dt} \Big|_{\text{system}}.$$

As we have an expression for the acceleration of a fluid element of mass dm moving in a velocity field we can write Newton's second law as the vector equation:

$$d\mathbf{F} = dm \frac{D\mathbf{V}}{Dt} = dm \left(u \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial z} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial t} \right).$$

Now we need a formulation for the force $d\mathbf{F}$ acting on the element.

4.4.1 Forces Acting on a Fluid Particle

We shall consider the x component of the force acting on a differential element of mass dm and volume $dV = dx dy dz$. Only stresses acting in the x direction will give rise to surface forces in the x direction. If the stresses at the center of the differential element are taken to be σ_{xx} , τ_{yx} , and τ_{zx} , then the stresses acting on the x direction can be obtained using a Taylor series expansion about the center of the element. The result of this is shown on Figure 4.7

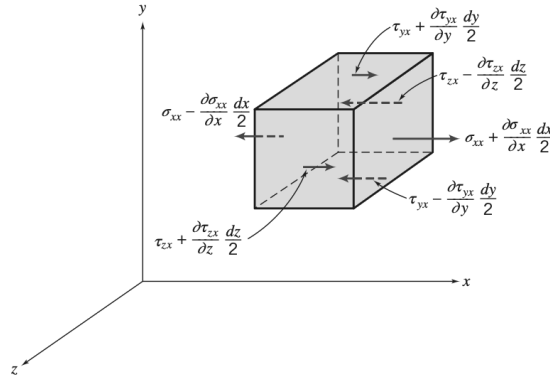


Figure 4.7: Stresses in the x direction on a fluid element.

To obtain the net surface force in the x direction dF_{S_x} we must sum the forces in the x -direction. On simplifying this we obtain:

$$dF_{S_x} = \left(\frac{\partial \sigma_{xx}}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial \tau_{yx}}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial \tau_{zx}}{\partial z} \right) dx dy dz.$$

Assuming the gravitational force is the only body force acting on the system, then the net force in the x direction dF_x is given by:

$$dF_x = dF_{B_x} + dF_{S_x} = \left(\rho g_x + \frac{\partial \sigma_{xx}}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial \tau_{yx}}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial \tau_{zx}}{\partial z} \right) dx dy dz.$$

Similarly for the force in the y and z directions:

$$\begin{aligned} dF_y &= dF_{B_y} + dF_{S_y} = \left(\rho g_y + \frac{\partial \tau_{xy}}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial \sigma_{yy}}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial \tau_{zy}}{\partial z} \right) dx dy dz \\ dF_z &= dF_{B_z} + dF_{S_z} = \left(\rho g_z + \frac{\partial \tau_{xz}}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial \tau_{yz}}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial \sigma_{zz}}{\partial z} \right) dx dy dz. \end{aligned}$$

4.4.2 Differential Momentum Equation

Now we have defined the force components acting on a fluid element of mass dm . If we substitute these expressions into Newton's second law from before we obtain the differential equations of motion,

$$\begin{aligned}\rho g_x + \frac{\partial \sigma_{xx}}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial \tau_{yx}}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial \tau_{zx}}{\partial z} &= \rho \left(\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} + u \frac{\partial u}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial u}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial u}{\partial z} \right) \\ \rho g_y + \frac{\partial \tau_{xy}}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial \sigma_{yy}}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial \tau_{zy}}{\partial z} &= \rho \left(\frac{\partial v}{\partial t} + u \frac{\partial v}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial v}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial v}{\partial z} \right) \\ \rho g_z + \frac{\partial \tau_{xz}}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial \tau_{yz}}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial \sigma_{zz}}{\partial z} &= \rho \left(\frac{\partial w}{\partial t} + u \frac{\partial w}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial w}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial w}{\partial z} \right).\end{aligned}$$

These are the differential equations of motion for any fluid satisfying the continuum assumption.

4.4.3 Newtonian Fluid: Navier-Stokes Equations

For a Newtonian fluid the viscous stress is directly proportional to the rate of shearing strain (the angular deformation rate). The stresses may be expressed in terms of velocity gradients and fluid properties in rectangular coordinates as:

$$\begin{aligned}\tau_{xy} &= \tau_{yx} = \mu \left(\frac{\partial v}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial u}{\partial y} \right) \\ \tau_{yz} &= \tau_{zy} = \mu \left(\frac{\partial w}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial v}{\partial z} \right) \\ \tau_{zx} &= \tau_{xz} = \mu \left(\frac{\partial u}{\partial z} + \frac{\partial w}{\partial x} \right) \\ \sigma_{xx} &= -p - \frac{2}{3} \mu \nabla \cdot \mathbf{V} + 2\mu \frac{\partial u}{\partial x} \\ \sigma_{yy} &= -p - \frac{2}{3} \mu \nabla \cdot \mathbf{V} + 2\mu \frac{\partial v}{\partial y} \\ \sigma_{zz} &= -p - \frac{2}{3} \mu \nabla \cdot \mathbf{V} + 2\mu \frac{\partial w}{\partial z}.\end{aligned}$$

There p is the local pressure. If these expressions for the stresses are introduced into the differential equations of motion we obtain:

$$\begin{aligned}\rho \frac{Du}{Dt} &= \rho g_x - \frac{\partial p}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial}{\partial x} \left(\mu \left(2 \frac{\partial u}{\partial x} - \frac{2}{3} \nabla \cdot \mathbf{V} \right) \right) + \frac{\partial}{\partial y} \left(\mu \left(\frac{\partial u}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial v}{\partial x} \right) \right) + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \left(\mu \left(\frac{\partial w}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial u}{\partial z} \right) \right) \\ \rho \frac{Dv}{Dt} &= \rho g_y - \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial}{\partial x} \left(\mu \left(\frac{\partial u}{\partial y} + \frac{\partial v}{\partial x} \right) \right) + \frac{\partial}{\partial y} \left(\mu \left(2 \frac{\partial v}{\partial y} - \frac{2}{3} \nabla \cdot \mathbf{V} \right) \right) + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \left(\mu \left(\frac{\partial v}{\partial z} + \frac{\partial w}{\partial y} \right) \right) \\ \rho \frac{Dw}{Dt} &= \rho g_z - \frac{\partial p}{\partial z} + \frac{\partial}{\partial x} \left(\mu \left(\frac{\partial w}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial u}{\partial z} \right) \right) + \frac{\partial}{\partial y} \left(\mu \left(\frac{\partial w}{\partial z} + \frac{\partial v}{\partial y} \right) \right) + \frac{\partial}{\partial z} \left(\mu \left(2 \frac{\partial w}{\partial z} - \frac{2}{3} \nabla \cdot \mathbf{V} \right) \right).\end{aligned}$$

These equations of motion are called the *Navier-Stokes equations*. For an incompressible flow these reduce to:

$$\begin{aligned}\rho \left(\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} + u \frac{\partial u}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial u}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial u}{\partial z} \right) &= \rho g_x - \frac{\partial p}{\partial x} + \mu \left(\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial z^2} \right) \\ \rho \left(\frac{\partial v}{\partial t} + u \frac{\partial v}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial v}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial v}{\partial z} \right) &= \rho g_y - \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} + \mu \left(\frac{\partial^2 v}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 v}{\partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^2 v}{\partial z^2} \right) \\ \rho \left(\frac{\partial w}{\partial t} + u \frac{\partial w}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial w}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial w}{\partial z} \right) &= \rho g_z - \frac{\partial p}{\partial z} + \mu \left(\frac{\partial^2 w}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 w}{\partial y^2} + \frac{\partial^2 w}{\partial z^2} \right).\end{aligned}$$

These describe many common flows so long as the fluids are Newtonian and incompressible.

Lecture 7: Euler and Bernoulli equation

15. September 2025

5 Incompressible Inviscid Flow

The Navier-Stokes equations introduced in subsection 4.4.3 describe fluid behaviour in a wide range of problems. However these are not analytically solvable except in simple cases. Instead of the Navier-Stokes equations we can instead use Euler's equation, which applies to an inviscid ($\mu = 0$) fluid (which itself is an idealized notion as no flow is truly inviscid).

5.1 Momentum Equation for Frictionless Flow: Euler's Equation

Euler's equation can be obtained from the Navier-Stokes equations simply by neglecting the viscous term. I.e.

$$\rho \frac{D\mathbf{V}}{Dt} = \rho \mathbf{g} - \nabla p \quad (20)$$

This states that for an inviscid flow, the change in momentum of a fluid particle is caused by the body force and the net pressure force. In rectangular coordinates this is

$$\begin{aligned} \rho \left(\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} + u \frac{\partial u}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial u}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial u}{\partial z} \right) &= \rho g_x - \frac{\partial p}{\partial x} \\ \rho \left(\frac{\partial v}{\partial t} + u \frac{\partial v}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial v}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial v}{\partial z} \right) &= \rho g_y - \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} \\ \rho \left(\frac{\partial w}{\partial t} + u \frac{\partial w}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial w}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial w}{\partial z} \right) &= \rho g_z - \frac{\partial p}{\partial z}. \end{aligned}$$

If the z -axis is vertical, then $\mathbf{g} = -g\hat{k} \implies g_x = g_y = 0, g_z = -g$.

In general, Equation 20 is applicable for any problem in which there is no viscous stresses. This also includes rigid-body motion problems.

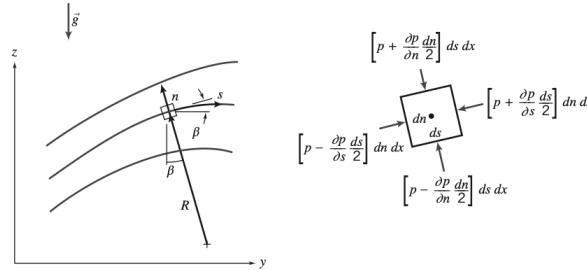


Figure 5.1: Fluid particle moving along a streamline.

We consider the flow in the yz -plane shown on Figure 5.1. Here our goal is to write the equations of motion in terms of the distance along the streamline s and the distance normal to the streamline n . The pressure at the center of the fluid element is assumed to be p . If we apply Newton's second law in the direction s of

the streamline, to the fluid element on Figure 5.1 with volume $ds \, dn \, dx$, neglecting viscous forces we obtain

$$\left(p - \frac{\partial p}{\partial s} \frac{ds}{2}\right) dn \, dx - \left(p + \frac{\partial p}{\partial s} \frac{ds}{2}\right) dn \, dx - \rho g \sin \beta \, ds \, dn \, dx = \rho a_s \, ds \, dn \, dx$$

where β is the angle between the tangent to the streamline and the horizontal, and a_s is the acceleration of the fluid particle along the streamline. By simplification, we obtain

$$-\frac{\partial p}{\partial s} - \rho g \sin \beta = \rho a_s.$$

Since $\sin \beta = \frac{\partial z}{\partial s}$, this can be written as

$$-\frac{1}{\rho} \frac{\partial p}{\partial s} - g \frac{\partial z}{\partial s} = a_s$$

which holds along any streamline $V = V(s, t)$. We remember that the total acceleration of a fluid particle in the streamwise direction is

$$a_s = \frac{DV}{Dt} = \frac{\partial V}{\partial t} + V \frac{\partial V}{\partial s}.$$

Hence Euler's equation in the streamwise direction with the z -axis directed vertically upward is

$$-\frac{1}{\rho} \frac{\partial p}{\partial s} - g \frac{\partial z}{\partial s} = \frac{\partial V}{\partial t} + V \frac{\partial V}{\partial s}.$$

For steady flow this reduces to

$$\frac{1}{\rho} \frac{\partial p}{\partial s} = -g \frac{\partial z}{\partial s} - V \frac{\partial V}{\partial s} \quad (21)$$

This indicates that the pressure along a streamline is influenced by the gravitational field and the velocity. The gravitational effect has already been described in section 2 – When $V = 0$, the pressure increases directly proportionally with the change in elevation. In the xy -plane, in which there is no influence of gravity Equation 21 reduces to

$$\frac{1}{\rho} \frac{\partial p}{\partial s} = -V \frac{\partial V}{\partial s}$$

which states that for an incompressible, inviscid flow a decrease in pressure will cause an increased velocity and v.v.

To obtain Euler's equation in a direction normal to the streamlines, we apply Newton's second law in the n direction to the fluid element. Again, neglecting viscous forces, we get

$$\left(p - \frac{\partial p}{\partial n} \frac{dn}{2}\right) ds \, dx - \left(p + \frac{\partial p}{\partial n} \frac{dn}{2}\right) ds \, dx - \rho g \cos \beta \, dn \, dx \, ds = \rho a_n \, dn \, dx \, ds$$

where β is the angle between the n -direction and the vertical and a_n is the acceleration of the fluid particle in the n -direction. On simplification this becomes

$$-\frac{\partial p}{\partial n} - \rho g \cos \beta = \rho a_n.$$

And since $\cos \beta = \frac{\partial z}{\partial n}$ this can be written as

$$-\frac{1}{\rho} \frac{\partial p}{\partial n} - g \frac{\partial z}{\partial n} = a_n.$$

The normal acceleration of the fluid element is toward the center of curvature of the streamline – in the $-n$ -direction. Hence

$$a_n = -\frac{V^2}{R}.$$

Therefore, for steady flow, where R is the radius of curvature of the streamline at the point chosen, Euler's equation normal to the streamline is

$$\frac{1}{\rho} \frac{\partial p}{\partial n} + g \frac{\partial z}{\partial n} = \frac{V^2}{R}.$$

In a horizontal plane this becomes

$$\frac{1}{\rho} \frac{\partial p}{\partial n} = \frac{V^2}{R}.$$

5.2 Bernoulli Equation: Integration of Euler's Equation Along a Streamline for Steady Flow

Compared to the Navier-Stokes equations the Euler's equation for incompressible inviscid flow is mathematically simpler – however solving it still presents difficulty in complex cases. One convenient approach to circumvent this for a steady flow is to integrate Euler's equation along a streamline.

5.2.1 Derivation of the Bernoulli Equation Using Streamline Coordinates

Euler's equation for steady flow along a streamline is given in Equation 21 as

$$-\frac{1}{\rho} \frac{\partial p}{\partial s} - g \frac{\partial z}{\partial s} = V \frac{\partial V}{\partial s}.$$

If a fluid particle moves an infinitesimal distance ds along a streamline, then

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{\partial p}{\partial s} ds &= dp && \text{(The change in pressure along } s) \\ \frac{\partial z}{\partial s} ds &= dz && \text{(The change in elevation along } s) \\ \frac{\partial V}{\partial s} dV &= dV && \text{(The change in speed along } s). \end{aligned}$$

Thus, by multiplying Equation 21 by ds we get

$$-\frac{dp}{\rho} - g dz = V dV \implies \frac{dp}{\rho} + V dV + g dz = 0 \quad (\text{along } s).$$

Integration of this equation gives

$$\int \frac{dp}{\rho} + \frac{V^2}{2} + gz = \text{constant} \quad (\text{along } s).$$

To use this one must first find the inverse change in density with pressure $\frac{1}{\rho} dp$. For incompressible flow $\rho = \text{constant}$ so the above equation becomes the Bernoulli equation,

$$\frac{p}{\rho} + \frac{V^2}{2} + gz = \text{constant} \quad (22)$$

For Equation 22 to be applicable the flow must be steady, incompressible, frictionless and happen along a streamline.

5.2.2 Derivation of the Bernoulli Equation Using Rectangular Coordinates

Instead of using Euler's equation on streamline-coordinate form as in subsubsection 5.2.1 one could also integrate the vector form of Euler's equation from Equation 20 along a streamline. As we are simply interested in the Bernoulli equation we will only consider the case of steady flow.

For steady flow, Euler's equation in rectangular coordinates is

$$\frac{D\mathbf{V}}{Dt} = u \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial y} + w \frac{\partial \mathbf{V}}{\partial z} = (\mathbf{V} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{V} = -\frac{1}{\rho} \nabla p - g \hat{k} \quad (23)$$

For steady flow the velocity field is $\mathbf{V} = \mathbf{V}(x, y, z)$. The motion of a particle along a streamline is governed by Equation 23. During the time interval dt the particle has a displacement $d\mathbf{s}$ along the streamline.

If we take the dot product of Equation 23 and the displacement $d\mathbf{s}$ along the streamline, a scalar equation relating pressure, speed, and elevation is obtained along the streamline. I.e.

$$(\mathbf{V} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{s} = -\frac{1}{\rho} \nabla p \cdot d\mathbf{s} - g \hat{k} \cdot d\mathbf{s}$$

where

$$d\mathbf{s} = dx \hat{i} + dy \hat{j} + dz \hat{k} \quad (\text{along } s).$$

Now we can evaluate each of the three terms one-by-one, starting with $-\frac{1}{\rho} \nabla p \cdot d\mathbf{s}$,

$$\begin{aligned} -\frac{1}{\rho} \nabla p \cdot d\mathbf{s} &= -\frac{1}{\rho} \left(\hat{i} \frac{\partial p}{\partial x} + \hat{j} \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} + \hat{k} \frac{\partial p}{\partial z} \right) \cdot (dx \hat{i} + dy \hat{j} + dz \hat{k}) & (\text{along } s) \\ &= -\frac{1}{\rho} \left(\frac{\partial p}{\partial x} dx + \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} dy + \frac{\partial p}{\partial z} dz \right) & (\text{along } s) \\ &= -\frac{1}{\rho} dp & (\text{along } s). \end{aligned}$$

Moving on to $-g \hat{k} \cdot d\mathbf{s}$, we get

$$\begin{aligned} -g \hat{k} \cdot d\mathbf{s} &= -g \hat{k} \cdot (dx \hat{i} + dy \hat{j} + dz \hat{k}) & (\text{along } s) \\ &= -g dz & (\text{along } s). \end{aligned}$$

Now we just need to evaluate $(\mathbf{V} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{s}$. A common vector identity allows us to rewrite this as

$$\begin{aligned} (\mathbf{V} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{s} &= \left(\frac{1}{2} \nabla (\mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{V}) - \mathbf{V} \times (\nabla \times \mathbf{V}) \right) \cdot d\mathbf{s} \\ &= \left(\frac{1}{2} \nabla (\mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{V}) \right) \cdot d\mathbf{s} - (\mathbf{V} \times (\nabla \times \mathbf{V})) \cdot d\mathbf{s}. \end{aligned}$$

The last term in this is zero, since $\mathbf{V}$ is parallel to $d\mathbf{s}$. Hence,

$$\begin{aligned} (\mathbf{V} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{s} &= \frac{1}{2} \nabla (\mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{V}) \cdot d\mathbf{s} & (\text{along } s) \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \nabla (V^2) \cdot d\mathbf{s} & (\text{along } s) \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \left(\hat{i} \frac{\partial V^2}{\partial x} + \hat{j} \frac{\partial V^2}{\partial y} + \hat{k} \frac{\partial V^2}{\partial z} \right) \cdot (dx \hat{i} + dy \hat{j} + dz \hat{k}) & (\text{along } s) \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \left(\frac{\partial V^2}{\partial x} dx + \frac{\partial V^2}{\partial y} dy + \frac{\partial V^2}{\partial z} dz \right) & (\text{along } s) \\ &= \frac{1}{2} d(V^2) & (\text{along } s). \end{aligned}$$

Substituting these three evaluated terms into the expression yields

$$\frac{dp}{\rho} + \frac{1}{2}d(V^2) + g dz = 0 \quad (\text{along } s).$$

Integrating this we obtain

$$\int \frac{dp}{\rho} + \frac{V^2}{2} + gz = \text{constant}.$$

And for constant density this becomes the Bernoulli equation, Equation 22,

$$\frac{p}{\rho} + \frac{V^2}{2} + gz = \text{constant}.$$

Once again, for Equation 22 to be applicable the flow must be steady, incompressible, frictionless and happen along a streamline.

5.2.3 Static, Stagnation, and Dynamic Pressures

The pressure p which is used in the Bernoulli equation, Equation 22 is the thermodynamic pressure, also called the *static pressure*. This is the pressure measured by an observer riding along with the fluid.

The *stagnation pressure* is obtained when a flowing fluid is decelerated to zero speed by a frictionless process. For incompressible flow, the Bernoulli equation can be used to relate changes in speed and pressure along a streamline for such a process. Neglecting elevation differences Equation 22 becomes

$$\frac{p}{\rho} + \frac{V^2}{2} = \text{constant}.$$

The stagnation pressure p_0 can then be computed by setting the stagnation speed $V_0 = 0$, as

$$\frac{p_0}{\rho} + 0 = \frac{p}{\rho} + \frac{V^2}{2} \implies p_0 = p + \frac{1}{2}\rho V^2 \quad (24)$$

This is the mathematical definition of stagnation pressure for incompressible flow. The term $\frac{1}{2}\rho V^2$ is called the *dynamic pressure*. Thus, the stagnation (or *total*) pressure is the sum of the static pressure and the dynamic pressure.

Solving Equation 24 for the local flow speed V yields

$$V = \sqrt{\frac{2(p_0 - p)}{\rho}}.$$

Thus if one knows the stagnation pressure and the local pressure one could calculate the corresponding flow speed.

Lecture 8: Bernoulli Equation Continued

17. September 2025

5.3 The Bernoulli Equation as an Energy Equation

The Bernoulli equation, Equation 22, has been derived by integration of Euler's equation along a streamline for a steady, incompressible, frictionless flow – I.e. it was derived from the momentum equation for a fluid particle.

Another equation, that looks almost identical to Equation 22, although requiring very different restrictions can be obtained from the first law of thermodynamics.

We consider steady flow in the absence of shear forces. We choose a control volume bounded by streamlines as shown on Figure 5.2, which is often called a *stream tube*.

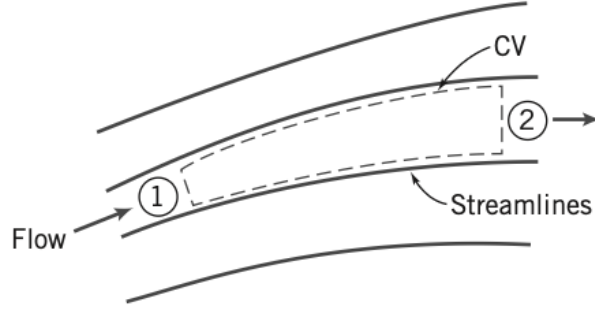


Figure 5.2: Flow through a stream tube.

We have previously defined the first law of thermodynamics on integral form as

$$\dot{Q} - \dot{W}_s - \dot{W}_{\text{shear}} - \dot{W}_{\text{other}} = \frac{\partial}{\partial t} \int_{\text{CV}} e \rho dV + \int_{\text{CS}} (e + pv) \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot d\mathbf{A}$$

where

$$e = u + \frac{V^2}{2} + gz.$$

Under the assumptions mentioned above we have

- $\dot{W}_s = 0$,
- $\dot{W}_{\text{shear}} = 0$,
- $\dot{W}_{\text{other}} = 0$,
- steady flow,
- and uniform flow and properties at each section.

This means that the first law of thermodynamics reduces to

$$\left(u_1 + p_1 v_1 + \frac{V_1^2}{2} + gz_1 \right) (-\rho_1 V_1 A_1) + \left(u_2 + p_2 v_2 + \frac{V_2^2}{2} + gz_2 \right) (\rho_2 V_2 A_2) - \dot{Q} = 0.$$

From continuity under the assumptions mentioned above we have:

$$\sum_{\text{CS}} \rho \mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{A} = 0$$

or

$$(-\rho_1 V_1 A_1) + (\rho_2 V_2 A_2) = 0.$$

I.e.

$$\dot{m} = \rho_1 V_1 A_1 = \rho_2 V_2 A_2.$$

Also

$$\dot{Q} = \frac{\delta Q}{dt} = \frac{\delta Q}{dm} \frac{dm}{dt} = \frac{\delta Q}{dm} \dot{m}.$$

Therefore, from the energy equation, after rearranging

$$\left(\left(p_2 v_2 + \frac{V_2^2}{2} + g z_2 \right) - \left(p_1 v_1 + \frac{V_1^2}{2} + g z_1 \right) \right) \dot{m} + \left(u_2 - u_1 - \frac{\delta Q}{dm} \right) \dot{m} = 0$$

or

$$p_1 v_1 + \frac{V_1^2}{2} + g z_1 = p_2 v_2 + \frac{V_2^2}{2}.$$

If we also assume the flow is incompressible then $v_1 = v_2 = \frac{1}{\rho}$ and,

$$\frac{p_1}{\rho} + \frac{V_1^2}{2} + g z_1 = \frac{p_2}{\rho} + \frac{V_2^2}{2} + g z_2 + \left(u_2 - u_1 - \frac{\delta Q}{dm} \right).$$

We can see that this reduces to the Bernoulli Equation, Equation 22 if the term in parentheses were zero. Therefore if we impose the further restriction,

$$\left(u_2 - u_1 - \frac{\delta Q}{dm} \right) = 0,$$

the energy equation reduces to

$$\frac{p_1}{\rho} + \frac{V_1^2}{2} + g z_1 = \frac{p_2}{\rho} + \frac{V_2^2}{2} + g z_2 \implies \frac{p}{\rho} + \frac{V^2}{2} + g z = \text{constant},$$

which is the Bernoulli equation.

Here we note that the Bernoulli equation has been derived in two different ways from entirely different frameworks. It may seem that the restriction, relating heat transfer and internal thermal energy change, is needed for the energy equation to transform to the Bernoulli equation. However, for an incompressible and frictionless flow without shear forces, heat transfer results only in a temperature change and does not affect neither pressure nor velocity.

5.4 Energy Grade Line and Hydraulic Grade Line

For a steady, incompressible, frictionless flow we may use the Bernoulli equation, Equation 22:

$$\frac{p}{\rho} + \frac{V^2}{2} + g z = \text{constant}.$$

If we divide this by g we obtain another form

$$\frac{p}{\rho g} + \frac{V^2}{2g} + z = H.$$

Here H is called the *total head* of the flow and is a measure of the total mechanical energy in units of meters. In a fluid flow H will not be constant but will instead continuously decrease as mechanical energy is converted to thermal. A useful graphical approach is to define this to be the *energy grade line* (EGL),

$$\text{EGL} = \frac{p}{\rho g} + \frac{V^2}{2g} + z.$$

We can also define the *hydraulic grade line* (HGL),

$$\text{HGL} = \frac{p}{\rho g} + z.$$

From these we get

$$\text{EGL} - \text{HGL} = \frac{V^2}{2g},$$

i.e. the difference between the EGL and HGL is the dynamic pressure term. The function of this is shown graphically on Figure 5.3. Here it is worth noting that for incompressible, inviscid flow without work devices the EGL is constant. Furthermore, the HGL will always be lower than the EGL by distance $\frac{V^2}{2g}$.

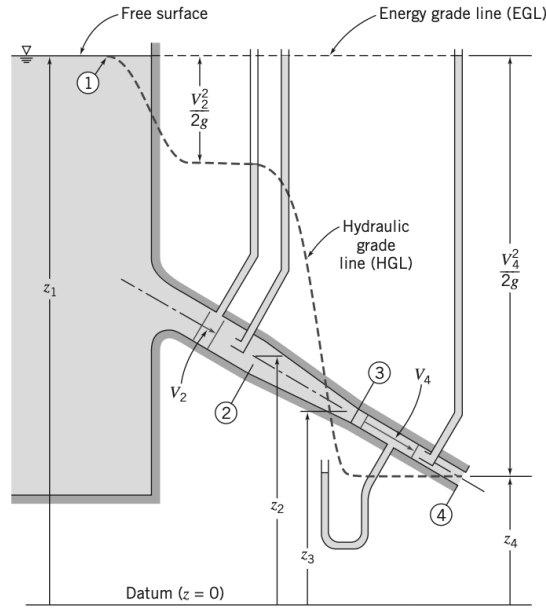


Figure 5.3: Energy and hydraulic grade lines for frictionless flow

5.5 Unsteady Bernoulli Equation: Integration of Euler's Equation Along a Streamline

The Bernoulli equation need not be restricted by the assumption of steady flow. The momentum equation for frictionless flow can be written (with $\mathbf{g}$ in the $-z$ direction) as

$$\frac{D\mathbf{V}}{Dt} = -\frac{1}{\rho}\nabla p - g\hat{k}.$$

This is a vector equation, which can be converted to a scalar equation by taking the dot product with $d\mathbf{s}$, where $d\mathbf{s}$ is an element of distance along a streamline. Thus

$$\frac{D\mathbf{V}}{Dt} \cdot d\mathbf{s} = \frac{D\mathbf{V}}{Dt} \cdot d\mathbf{s} = V \frac{\partial V}{\partial s} ds + \frac{\partial V}{\partial t} ds = -\frac{1}{\rho} \nabla p \cdot d\mathbf{s} - g\hat{k} \cdot d\mathbf{s}.$$

Here we note that

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{\partial V}{\partial s} ds &= dV && \text{(the change in } V \text{ along } s) \\ \nabla p \cdot ds &= dp && \text{(the change in pressure along } s) \\ \hat{j} \cdot ds &= dz && \text{(the change in } z \text{ along } s).\end{aligned}$$

Substituting these into the expression we obtain

$$V dV + \frac{\partial V}{\partial t} ds = -\frac{dp}{\rho} - g dz.$$

Integrating this along a streamline from a point, 1, to another point, 2, yields

$$\int_1^2 \frac{dp}{\rho} + \frac{V_2^2 - V_1^2}{2} + g(z_2 - z_1) + \int_1^2 \frac{\partial V}{\partial t} ds = 0.$$

For incompressible flow, $\rho = \text{constant}$, and the above equation then reduces to

$$\frac{p_1}{\rho} + \frac{V_1^2}{2} + gz_1 = \frac{p_2}{\rho} + \frac{V_2^2}{2} + gz_2 + \int_1^2 \frac{\partial V}{\partial t} ds.$$

This is applicable for incompressible, frictionless flow along a streamline. This is also known as the Bernoulli equation for unsteady flow. It differs from the Bernoulli equation by the term $\int_1^2 \frac{\partial V}{\partial t} ds$. This term can be interpreted as the work involved in the rate of increase of momentum of the fluid on the streamline over time, as opposed to the change in momentum over distance, represented by the change in velocity from V_1 to V_2 .

5.6 Irrotational Flow

Irrotational flows were briefly mentioned in subsection 4.3.2. These are flows in which the fluid particles do not rotate ($\boldsymbol{\omega} = 0$). The only stresses that can generate particle rotation are shear stresses. Therefore, all inviscid flows are inherently irrotational unless the particles were somehow initially rotating. The irrotationality condition is

$$\nabla \times \mathbf{V} = 0 \implies \frac{\partial w}{\partial y} - \frac{\partial v}{\partial z} = \frac{\partial u}{\partial z} - \frac{\partial w}{\partial x} = \frac{\partial v}{\partial x} - \frac{\partial u}{\partial y} = 0.$$

5.6.1 Bernoulli Equation Applied to Irrotational Flow

The Bernoulli equation has been shown to hold along a streamline for a steady, incompressible, inviscid flow. If in addition to this, the flow field is also irrotational (i.e. the particles had no initial rotation), such that $\nabla \times \mathbf{V} = 0$, then Bernoulli's equation will be the same value for all streamlines – this means that for irrotational flows the Bernoulli equation is also valid across different streamlines.

To show this we start with Euler's equation in vector form,

$$(\mathbf{V} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{V} = -\frac{1}{\rho} \nabla p - g \hat{k}.$$

Using the vector identity

$$(\mathbf{V} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{V} = \frac{1}{2} \nabla (\mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{V}) - \mathbf{V} \times (\nabla \times \mathbf{V}),$$

we see that for irrotational flow, when $\nabla \times \mathbf{V} = 0$,

$$(\mathbf{V} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{V} = \frac{1}{2} \nabla (\mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{V})$$

hence Euler's equation for irrotational flow can be written as

$$\frac{1}{2} \nabla (\mathbf{V} \cdot \mathbf{V}) = \frac{1}{2} \nabla (V^2) = -\frac{1}{\rho} \nabla p - g \hat{k}.$$

We consider an arbitrary displacement from $\mathbf{r}$ to $\mathbf{r} + d\mathbf{r}$ not necessarily along a streamline. Taking the dot product of this with each term in the above yields

$$\frac{1}{2} \nabla (V^2) \cdot d\mathbf{r} = -\frac{1}{\rho} \nabla p \cdot d\mathbf{r} - g \hat{k} \cdot d\mathbf{r}$$

hence

$$\frac{1}{2} d(V^2) = -\frac{dp}{\rho} - g dz$$

or

$$\frac{dp}{\rho} + \frac{1}{2} d(V^2) + g dz = 0.$$

Integrating this for an incompressible flow gives

$$\frac{p}{\rho} + \frac{V^2}{2} + gz = \text{constant}$$

which is the Bernoulli equation. Therefore it has been shown that this holds between any two general points in an irrotational flow.

Lecture 9: Dimensional Analysis

22. September 2025

6 Dimensional Analysis and Similitude

Many phenomena in fluid mechanics depend on complex interplay between geometry and flow phenomena. E.g. consider the drag force on a stationary smooth sphere immersed in a uniform stream. We expect this to depend on the size of the sphere (defined by the diameter, D), the fluid speed V , the fluid density ρ and the fluid viscosity μ . If the drag force is called F this can be written symbolically as

$$F = f(D, V, \rho, \mu).$$

If we then wanted to determine how F depends on V , D , ρ , and μ we could not simply vary one parameter at a time in an experimental setting one by one as with just four parameters with 10 different experimental runs at different values each we have 10^4 different experiments.

Instead of doing this extremely cumbersome task we can use dimensional analysis to show that all the data for drag on a smooth sphere can be plotted as a single relationship between two nondimensional parameters in the form

$$\frac{F}{\rho V^2 D^2} = f\left(\frac{\rho V D}{\mu}\right).$$

The form of the function f must still be determined experimentally, however all spheres, in all fluids, for most velocities are expected to fall on this same function curve. This includes everything from the drag on a hot-air balloon to red blood cells moving through an aorta.

6.1 Nondimensionalizing the Basic Differential Equations

We consider a steady, incompressible two-dimensional flow of a Newtonian fluid with constant viscosity. The mass conservation equation becomes

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial x} + \frac{\partial v}{\partial y} = 0 \quad (25)$$

and the Navier-Stokes equations reduce to

$$\rho \left(u \frac{\partial u}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial u}{\partial y} \right) = -\frac{\partial p}{\partial x} + \mu \left(\frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial y^2} \right) \quad (26)$$

$$\rho \left(u \frac{\partial v}{\partial x} + v \frac{\partial v}{\partial y} \right) = -\rho g - \frac{\partial p}{\partial y} + \mu \left(\frac{\partial^2 v}{\partial x^2} + \frac{\partial^2 v}{\partial y^2} \right). \quad (27)$$

These equations form a set of coupled nonlinear partial differential equations for u , v , and p , and are rather cumbersome to solve for most flows. The mass conservation equation, Equation 25, here has dimensions of $\left[\frac{1}{\text{time}}\right]$, and the Navier-Stokes equations, eqs. (26) and (27), have dimensions of $\left[\frac{\text{force}}{\text{volume}}\right]$. We will now try to convert these to dimensionless equations.

To nondimensionalize these equations, we divide all lengths by a reference length L and all the velocities by a reference speed V_∞ often taken as the freestream velocity. Furthermore, we make the pressure nondimensional by dividing by ρV_∞^2 . If we denote the nondimensional quantities with asterisks, we obtain

$$x^* = \frac{x}{L}, \quad y^* = \frac{y}{L}, \quad u^* = \frac{u}{V_\infty}, \quad v^* = \frac{v}{V_\infty}, \quad p^* = \frac{p}{\rho V_\infty^2}.$$

If we substitute this into eqs. (25) to (27) we get

$$\frac{V_\infty}{L} \frac{\partial u^*}{\partial x^*} + \frac{V_\infty}{L} \frac{\partial v^*}{\partial y^*} = 0 \quad (28)$$

$$\frac{\rho V_\infty^2}{L} \left(u^* \frac{\partial u^*}{\partial x^*} + v^* \frac{\partial u^*}{\partial y^*} \right) = -\frac{\rho V_\infty^2}{L} \frac{\partial p^*}{\partial x^*} + \frac{\mu V_\infty}{L^2} \left(\frac{\partial^2 u^*}{\partial x^{*2}} + \frac{\partial^2 u^*}{\partial y^{*2}} \right) \quad (29)$$

$$\frac{\rho V_\infty^2}{L} \left(u^* \frac{\partial v^*}{\partial x^*} + v^* \frac{\partial v^*}{\partial y^*} \right) = -\rho g - \frac{\rho V_\infty^2}{L} \frac{\partial p^*}{\partial y^*} + \frac{\mu V_\infty}{L^2} \left(\frac{\partial^2 v^*}{\partial x^{*2}} + \frac{\partial^2 v^*}{\partial y^{*2}} \right) \quad (30)$$

$$\cdot \quad (31)$$

Dividing Equation (28) by $\frac{V_\infty}{L}$ and Equations (29) and (30) by $\frac{\rho V_\infty^2}{L}$ yields

$$\frac{\partial u^*}{\partial x^*} + \frac{\partial v^*}{\partial y^*} = 0 \quad (32)$$

$$u^* \frac{\partial u^*}{\partial x^*} + v^* \frac{\partial u^*}{\partial y^*} = -\frac{\partial p^*}{\partial x^*} + \frac{\mu}{\rho V_\infty L} \left(\frac{\partial^2 u^*}{\partial x^{*2}} + \frac{\partial^2 u^*}{\partial x^{*2}} + \frac{\partial^2 u^*}{\partial y^{*1}} \right) \quad (33)$$

$$u^* \frac{\partial v^*}{\partial x^*} + v^* \frac{\partial v^*}{\partial y^*} = -\frac{gL}{V_\infty^2} - \frac{\partial p^*}{\partial y^*} + \frac{\mu}{\rho V_\infty L} \left(\frac{\partial^2 v^*}{\partial x^{*2}} + \frac{\partial^2 v^*}{\partial y^{*2}} \right). \quad (34)$$

???? and eq. (33) are the nondimensional forms of our original equations, Equations (25) to (27).

6.2 Buckingham Pi Theorem

At the start of Section 6 it was discussed how the drag F on a sphere can be modelled as

$$F = F(D, \rho, \mu, V)$$

where either theory or experiment is needed to determine the nature of the function f . More formally, we write

$$g(F, D, \rho, \mu, V) = 0$$

where g is an unspecified function, different from f . The Buckingham Pi theorem states that we can transform a relationship between n parameters of the form

$$g(q_1, q_2, \dots, q_n) = 0$$

into a corresponding relationship between $n - m$ independent dimensionless Π parameters in the form

$$G(\Pi_1, \Pi_2, \dots, \Pi_{n-m}) = 0$$

or

$$\Pi_1 = G_1(\Pi_2, \dots, \Pi_{n-m})$$

where m usually is the minimum number r of independent dimensions (e.g. mass, length, time) required to define the dimensions of all the parameters $q_1, q_2, \dots, q_n$. For the sphere problem it can be shown that

$$g(F, D, \rho, \mu, V) = 0 \quad \text{or} \quad F = F(D, \rho, \mu, V)$$

leads to

$$G\left(\frac{F}{\rho V^2 D^2}, \frac{\mu}{\rho V D}\right) = 0 \quad \text{or} \quad \frac{F}{\rho V^2 D^2} = G_1\left(\frac{\mu}{\rho V D}\right).$$

The theorem does not predict the form of neither G nor G_1 . I.e. the functional relation among the independent dimensionless Π parameters must be determined experimentally.

The $n - m$ dimensionless Π parameters obtained from this procedure are independent. A Π parameter is not said to be independent if it can be formed from any combination of one or more of the other Π parameters.

The following six steps outline the normal procedure for determining the Π parameters

1. List all the dimensional parameters involved. Let n be the number of parameters. If not all the important parameters are included then a relation will still be obtained however it will not give the full story. If parameters that actually have no effect are included these will either vanish during the dimensional analysis or result in extraneous dimensional groups that do not have any effect.
2. Select a set of fundamental (or primary) dimensions, e.g. MLt or FLt . For a heat transfer problem it might be wise to include T for temperature and in electrical systems q for charge and so on.
3. List the dimensions of all parameters in terms of primary dimensions. Let r be the number of primary dimensions. Either force or mass may be selected as a primary dimension.
4. Select a set of r dimensional parameters that includes all the primary dimensions. These parameters will all be combined with each of the remaining parameters, one at a time, and will therefore be called *repeating parameters*. No repeating parameter should have dimensions that are a power of the dimensions of another repeating parameter, e.g. do not include both an area $[L^2]$ and a second moment $[L^4]$ as repeating parameters. The repeating parameter chosen may appear in all the dimensionless groups obtained. Therefore one should not include the dependent parameter in the repeating parameters.
5. Set up dimensional equations, combining the parameters selected in the previous step with each of the other parameters, in turn, to form dimensionless groups. There will be $n - m$ equations. Solve the dimensional equations to obtain the $n - m$ dimensionless groups.
6. Check to see that each group obtained is actually dimensionless. If mass was initially selected as a primary dimension, it is wise to check the groups using force as a primary dimension, or vice versa.

The functional relationship among the Π parameters obtained from the above method must be determined by experiment.

The $n - m$ dimensionless groups obtained by this procedure are independent but not unique. If a different set of repeating parameters is chosen different dimensionless groups are found. Based on experience viscosity should appear in only one dimensionless parameter. Therefore μ should not be chosen as a repeating parameter as these may appear in all the dimensionless groups obtained.

It usually works best to choose density $\rho = [\frac{M}{L^3}]$, speed $V = [\frac{L}{t}]$, and characteristic length L as repeating parameters as these typically lead to dimensionless parameters suitable for a wide range of data and they are all easily measurable.

6.3 Significant Dimensionless Groups in Fluid Mechanics

Many important dimensionless groups have been identified. Several of these are so fundamental they are worth remembering.

The typical forces encountered in flowing fluids are due to inertia, viscosity, pressure, gravity, surface tension, and compressibility. The ratio of any two forces will be dimensionless. It has previously been shown that the inertia force is proportional to $\rho V^2 L^2$. hence, we can compare the relative magnitude of various fluid forces to the inertia force:

Viscous Force	$\sim \tau A = \mu \frac{du}{dy} A \propto \mu \frac{V}{L} L^2 = \mu V L$	so	$\frac{\text{viscous}}{\text{inertia}}$	$\sim \frac{\mu V L}{\rho V^2 L^2} = \frac{\mu}{\rho V L}$
Pressure Force	$\sim \Delta p A \propto \Delta p L^2$	so	$\frac{\text{pressure}}{\text{inertia}}$	$\sim \frac{\Delta p L^2}{\rho V^2 L^2} = \frac{\Delta p}{\rho V^2}$
Gravity Force	$\sim mg \propto g \rho L^3$	so	$\frac{\text{gravity}}{\text{inertia}}$	$\sim \frac{g \rho L^3}{\rho V^2 L^2} = \frac{gL}{V^2}$
Surface Tension	$\sim \sigma L$	so	$\frac{\text{Surface Tension}}{\text{inertia}}$	$\sim \frac{\sigma L}{\rho V^2 L^2} = \frac{\sigma}{\rho V^2 L}$
Compressibility Force	$\sim E_v A \propto E_v L^2$	so	$\frac{\text{Compressibility}}{\text{inertia}}$	$\sim \frac{E_v L^2}{\rho V^2 L^2} = \frac{E_v}{\rho V^2}$

All of these occur so frequently that they have been given identifying names.

The first parameter $\frac{\mu}{\rho V L}$, is by tradition inverted to the form $\frac{\rho V L}{\mu}$. This is termed *Reynolds number* after Osborne Reynolds who discovered that

$$\text{Re} = \frac{\rho \bar{V} D}{\mu} = \frac{\bar{V} D}{\nu}$$

is a criterion by which the flow regime may be determined. In general this is

$$\text{Re} = \frac{\rho V L}{\mu} = \frac{V L}{\nu}$$

where L is a characteristic length descriptive of the flow field geometry. The Reynolds number can be seen as the ratio of inertia forces to viscous forces. Flows with “large” Reynolds numbers are generally more turbulent and flows in which the inertia forces are “small” compared to the viscous forces are characteristically laminar.

In aerodynamics, the second parameter, $\frac{\Delta p}{\rho V^2}$ is normally modified by inserting a factor $\frac{1}{2}$ in the denominator such that it represents the dynamic pressure. The ratio

$$\text{Eu} = \frac{\Delta p}{\frac{1}{2} \rho V^2}$$

is formed, where Δp is the local pressure minus the freestream pressure, and ρ and V are properties of the freestream flow. This ratio is called the *Euler number* (not to be confused with Euler's number e) named after Leonhard Euler. This is also sometimes called the *pressure coefficient*, C_p .

When studying cavitation, the pressure difference, Δp , is taken as $\Delta p = p - p_v$ where p is the pressure in the liquid stream and p_v is the vapor pressure at the test temperature. Combining these with ρ and V in the stream yields the dimensionless parameter called the *cavitation number*,

$$\text{Ca} = \frac{p - p_v}{\frac{1}{2}\rho V^2}.$$

The smaller the cavitation number, the more likely cavitation is to occur. This is usually unwanted.

William Froude and his son Robert E. Froude are credited with discovering that the parameter

$$\text{Fr} = \frac{V}{\sqrt{gL}}$$

was significant for flows with free surface effects. Squaring the *Froude number* gives

$$\text{Fr}^2 = \frac{V^2}{gL}$$

which is the ratio of inertia to gravity (the inverse of the third ratio above). The length L is, once again, a characteristic length descriptive of the flow field. For open-channel flow L will equal the water depth. Froude numbers less than unity indicate subcritical flow and values greater than unity represents supercritical flow.

By convention the inverse of the fourth force ratio $\frac{\sigma}{\rho V^2 L}$ is called the *Weber number* and indicates the ratio of inertia to surface tension forces,

$$\text{We} = \frac{\rho V^2 L}{\sigma}.$$

The value of the Weber number is indicative of the existence of and frequency of capillary waves at a free surface.

Ernst Mach introduced the parameter

$$M = \frac{V}{c}$$

where V is the flow speed and c is the local sonic speed. This is a key parameter that characterizes compressibility effects in a flow. This may also be written as:

$$M = \frac{V}{c} = \frac{V}{\sqrt{\frac{dp}{d\rho}}} = \frac{V}{\sqrt{\frac{E_v}{\rho}}} \implies M^2 = \frac{\rho V^2 L^2}{E_v L^2} = \frac{\rho V^2}{E_v}$$

which is the inverse of the final force ratio $\frac{E_v}{\rho V^2}$ discussed above. For truly incompressible flow, $c = \infty$ so $M = 0$